

ENGLISH FOR ENVIRONMENTAL PROFESSIONALS

Environmental Consulting English

Define the boundary. Trace the evidence. Explain the finding.

Phil Stilwell

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Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For environmental consultants, field coordinators, project managers, and sustainability teams.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight consulting conversations: qualify a site assessment, investigate a custody gap, clarify an agency request, compare remediation proposals, report audit progress, correct an emissions claim, address residents, and negotiate a scope change.

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02 Sampling Plans and Data Quality

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Make the limits as clear as the findings

An environmental result belongs to a location, period, method, and question. These conversations practice preserving those boundaries while explaining evidence to clients, agencies, colleagues, and the public.

Separate absence from evidence

A missing record does not establish either a clean site or a release. Explain what is missing, who will assess its significance, and what conclusion remains unsupported.

"The tank-closure record is missing; its significance still requires review."

Keep the evidence traceable

Report a documentation gap without inventing the missing event or silently repairing the original. Distinguish a quality review from a final decision about whether data can support a particular use.

"The receiving signature is blank; the data-usability review remains open."

Name the comparison basis

Implementation duration is not the whole remediation period, and selected electricity emissions are not an organization-wide footprint. State included activities and excluded costs or sources.

"These totals include the stated monitoring costs, but technical suitability is still unresolved."

Translate uncertainty respectfully

Residents may hear a narrow technical statement as a broad reassurance. Acknowledge the practical question and explain exactly which places, substances, and conditions were assessed.

"These results cover three locations on one morning; they do not characterize the entire area."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All sites, people, projects, figures, and local procedures are fictional. This book teaches professional English, not environmental, engineering, legal, health, or investment advice. Actual assessment, sampling, remediation, regulatory, and safety decisions require qualified professionals using applicable requirements. No exercise certifies a site, establishes safe exposure, or authorizes field work.

A missing record is not a clean-site conclusion

A Read the situation

Qualify an assessment summary and explain the significance review without guessing its outcome.

A buyer is reviewing the former Bell workshop site. Consultant Maya has completed the scheduled site visit, interviews, and available historical-record review. The tank-closure record requested from the archive has not arrived. Environmental professional Eric has not yet assessed the significance of that gap. A draft executive summary says no further questions remain. No sampling is included in the current Phase I scope, and no Phase II investigation has been authorized. Maya will contact the archive and give Eric a status update on Tuesday at 14:00; receipt of the record by then is not guaranteed.

PEOPLE / Maya: Project consultant | Eric: Environmental professional

A QUALIFICATION IS USEFUL INFORMATION

A client may interpret a cautious phrase as indecision. Tie the qualification to a specific missing source and a named review step. Do not use broad reassurance to make an incomplete evidential position sound more commercially convenient.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which information is missing?

- | | |
|----------------------------------|---|
| A All interview records | B The tank-closure record |
| C Every historical source | D The completed site-visit notes |

2. What is authorized now?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A A clean-site certificate | B The current Phase I scope, without sampling |
| C An unrestricted Phase II investigation | D Excavation of every tank |

3. What is promised for Tuesday at 14:00?

- | | |
|------------------------------------|--|
| A Completed soil sampling | B A status update |
| C Guaranteed record receipt | D A final clean-site conclusion |

Answers and explanations: [page 76](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

Phase I environmental site assessment

An inquiry into a property's environmental conditions using specified assessment methods.

IN USE conduct a Phase I assessment

Phase II investigation

A further investigation that may include sampling to address identified questions.

IN USE scope a Phase II investigation

historical land use

Past uses of a property or surrounding land.

IN USE investigate historical land use

records review

Examination of documents relevant to an assessment question.

IN USE complete the records review

site reconnaissance

Observational examination of a site as part of an assessment.

IN USE document site reconnaissance

tank-closure record

Documentation concerning the closure of a storage tank.

IN USE request the tank-closure record

all appropriate inquiries (AAI)

A U.S. environmental inquiry framework relevant to specified property transactions.

IN USE evaluate AAI requirements

environmental professional

A professional meeting the applicable qualifications for the assessment role.

IN USE refer to the environmental professional

data gap

Missing or unavailable information relevant to an assessment.

IN USE identify a data gap

release

An escape or discharge of a substance into the environment.

IN USE investigate a reported release

source limitation

A restriction affecting what a source can establish.

IN USE disclose a source limitation

scope of inquiry

The defined questions and work included in an assessment.

IN USE confirm the scope of inquiry

Precision check

A data gap is not automatically a significant data gap, and neither label alone proves a release. The environmental professional evaluates its significance using the assessment context and applicable requirements.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

recognized environmental condition (REC)

A defined assessment classification concerning specified hazardous-substance or petroleum conditions.

IN USE evaluate a potential REC

historical aerial photograph

An overhead image documenting past site appearance.

IN USE compare historical aerial photographs

fire insurance map

A historical map that may describe buildings and past uses.

IN USE review a fire insurance map

regulatory database

Organized agency information about regulated sites or activities.

IN USE search a regulatory database

adjoining property

A property directly next to the subject site.

IN USE review adjoining property uses

subject property

The property being assessed.

IN USE define the subject property

significant data gap

A gap that affects the professional's ability to identify relevant environmental conditions.

IN USE assess a significant data gap

interview record

Documentation of information obtained from an interview.

IN USE retain the interview record

professional opinion

A qualified interpretation based on evidence and applicable practice.

IN USE support a professional opinion

follow-up request

A further request for information or action.

IN USE issue a follow-up request

executive summary

A concise account of major findings and qualifications.

IN USE qualify the executive summary

authorization

Permission to undertake specified work.

IN USE obtain investigation authorization

Precision check

Phase I and Phase II are not synonyms for safe and unsafe. A further investigation addresses defined questions; its need, scope, and authorization must be established rather than inferred from a missing document.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE OUTSTANDING SOURCE

"The tank-closure record has not arrived."

LIMIT THE CONCLUSION

"We cannot say that no further questions remain."

REQUEST PROFESSIONAL REVIEW

"Please assess the significance of this gap."

STATE THE EXISTING SCOPE

"Sampling is outside the current Phase I scope."

NAME COMPLETED WORK

"The scheduled visit, interviews, and available records review are complete."

SEPARATE ABSENCE FROM PROOF

"A missing record does not prove either a release or its absence."

PRESERVE A CLASSIFICATION

"We have not classified the gap as significant."

AVOID AN AUTOMATIC NEXT STEP

"No Phase II investigation has been authorized."

Has not arrived

Describes a missing source without speculating about its contents.

No further questions

A broad conclusion unsupported by the outstanding review.

Significance

Refers to the gap's effect on interpretation, not simply its existence.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

GIVE A TRACEABLE REQUEST

"I will follow up with the archive."

AVOID A RECEIPT PROMISE

"The archive has not guaranteed delivery by then."

KEEP THE SOURCE VISIBLE

"Cite the missing record beside the qualification."

CLARIFY AUTHORITY

"A proposed investigation is not permission to start."

DISTINGUISH A COMMITMENT

"Tuesday at 14:00 is our status-update time."

QUALIFY THE SUMMARY

"The conclusion remains subject to review of the outstanding information."

EXPLAIN THE PURPOSE

"Further investigation would address a defined unresolved question."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"I will report the archive response and any continuing limitation."

Subject to review

Makes an unresolved condition explicit.

Outside scope

Identifies work not included in the current agreement.

By versus at

Delivery by a time differs from an update at that time.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which summary is supported?

- A** The completed visit proves the site is clean.
- B** Phase II work starts automatically tomorrow.
- C** The tank-closure record remains outstanding, and its significance requires review.
- D** Missing paperwork proves contamination.

2. Who assesses the gap's significance?

- A** The archive delivery driver
- B** Any reader who prefers a definite answer
- C** Eric in the environmental-professional role
- D** The buyer solely because of the purchase deadline

3. Which statement improperly broadens the scope?

- A** A follow-up investigation may need a defined scope.
- B** The summary needs a qualification.
- C** Sampling is already authorized under this Phase I assignment.
- D** The archive request remains open.

4. What should Maya report if the record is still missing on Tuesday?

- A** The outstanding status and the continuing review limitation
- B** That delivery occurred because the update was promised
- C** A guessed tank-closure date
- D** A final absence-of-release finding

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

A missing record is not a clean-site conclusion

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

records review / authorization / source limitation / subject property / follow-up request / release / professional opinion / scope of inquiry / data gap / executive summary

- 01 **Maya:** The draft says no further questions remain. We have finished the visit and interviews, but the tank-closure record is still missing. Can that sentence stay?
- 02 **Eric:** No. The outstanding record creates a ¹ _____. We need to describe it before I assess how it affects the conclusions. Completed work does not erase that unresolved source.
- 03 **Maya:** The buyer wants a short answer today. Would it be fair to say that the missing document means the property has an environmental problem?
- 04 **Eric:** That also goes too far. A missing document is not evidence of a ² _____. We must distinguish the absence of information from a finding about what happened at the property.
- 05 **Maya:** The archive might send it tomorrow, although it has given no commitment. I can follow up and identify the request number in our project record.
- 06 **Eric:** Good. Retain that ³ _____ and any response. Do not imply that the source is unavailable forever simply because it has not arrived for this draft.
- 07 **Maya:** Should I label the gap significant now so that nobody overlooks it? That would certainly draw attention to the outstanding record in the summary.
- 08 **Eric:** Do not preempt the ⁴ _____. We can make the issue prominent without deciding its significance before the relevant assessment. The distinction matters to the client.
- 09 **Maya:** Another colleague suggested scheduling samples immediately. Sampling is not in our present assignment, and the client has not approved any additional investigation.
- 10 **Eric:** Then keep the ⁵ _____ explicit. A further investigation would need a defined question, appropriate professional input, and the necessary authorization. This conversation does not supply those things.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Maya:** I will avoid saying that Phase II work has started. Can the summary list the work completed while clearly leaving the record question open?
- 12 **Eric:** Yes. Revise the ⁶ _____ to name the outstanding tank-closure record and the pending significance review. Do not bury the qualification where a reader is unlikely to see it.
- 13 **Maya:** Could the buyer interpret pending review as proof that every other source is unreliable? We have useful interviews and historical records already.
- 14 **Eric:** Describe the specific ⁷ _____, not a wholesale failure. The other material remains part of the evidence, with its own context. Precision avoids both false reassurance and unnecessary alarm.
- 15 **Maya:** I will contact the archive and update you Tuesday at fourteen hundred, whether or not the record arrives. That gives us a clear next contact.
- 16 **Eric:** Correct. The update is not ⁸ _____ for sampling or a promise of a final conclusion. Keep the two commitments separate when explaining the next step to the buyer.
- 17 **Maya:** The revised wording will say the outstanding information requires your review. It will not say the site is clean or that contamination has been established.
- 18 **Eric:** That preserves the ⁹ _____ position. We can explain exactly what is complete, what remains missing, and who will evaluate the consequence without guessing the answer.
- 19 **Maya:** I will circulate that revision with the archive request reference and the Tuesday update time. No additional field work will be represented as approved.
- 20 **Eric:** Agreed. Keep the ¹⁰ _____ and assessment boundaries clear throughout. The client needs a useful, limited statement grounded in this site's evidence, not a slogan about every possible environmental condition.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. data gap | 2. release | 3. follow-up request | 4. professional opinion | 5. scope of inquiry | 6. executive summary | 7. source limitation | 8. authorization | 9. records review | 10. subject property

Repair a second assessment update

F Say it

For the Park site, an old solvent-storage record is missing. Nora will assess its significance. The current assignment excludes sampling. An archive status update is due Friday at 11:00.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

sampling / Nora / solvent-storage / Friday at 11:00

Consultant: "The outstanding source is the ¹ _____ record."

Reviewer: "The person assessing significance is ² _____."

Consultant: "The present assignment excludes ³ _____."

Reviewer: "The archive status update is due ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. solvent-storage | 2. Nora | 3. sampling | 4. Friday at 11:00

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Trace a missing custody signature without inventing it

A Read the situation

Describe a documentation deviation and distinguish review status from data acceptance.

Project plan P6 requires a receiving signature for the direct handoff from the field team to the laboratory custodian. For sample GW03, the sender signed, the receiving-signature box is blank, and the laboratory receipt log records arrival at 16:25. The bottle identifier matches the submission sheet. An analytical result is available, but quality reviewer Jonas has not decided its usability for the project question. Field coordinator Elena must report the discrepancy, preserve the original record, and seek a traceable clarification. These are stated project requirements, not universal rules about carrier signatures.

PEOPLE / Elena: Field coordinator | Jonas: Quality reviewer

INVESTIGATE THE GAP WITHOUT ACCUSING A COLLEAGUE

A missing signature can trigger blame before the event has been established. Describe the exact field and supporting records. Request a documented clarification rather than asking someone to fill a blank as though the original record had always been complete.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is missing?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A The analytical result | B The sender's signature |
| C The laboratory custodian's receiving signature | D The sample identifier on every bottle |

2. What does the receipt log establish in this case?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|---|
| A A final usability decision | B Recorded laboratory arrival at 16:25 |
| C A complete custody record | D Guaranteed analytical accuracy |

3. What is the correct current data status?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A The signature has already been reconstructed. | B Usability remains under review. |
| C The result is automatically invalid. | D The result is approved for every purpose. |

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

sampling plan

A document defining the intended collection and analysis of samples.

IN USE follow the sampling plan

data quality objective (DQO)

A statement of the data needed to support a specified decision.

IN USE define a data quality objective

quality assurance project plan (QAPP)

A plan describing quality requirements and activities for a project.

IN USE review the QAPP

chain of custody (COC)

The documented possession and transfer history of a sample or evidence.

IN USE maintain chain of custody

custodian

A person responsible for possession or care of a sample.

IN USE identify the receiving custodian

sample identifier

The unique label linking a sample to its records.

IN USE verify the sample identifier

receipt log

A record of received items and associated information.

IN USE check the receipt log

transfer signature

A signature documenting a specified custody handoff.

IN USE obtain the required transfer signature

deviation

A departure from a stated procedure or requirement.

IN USE document a deviation

traceable amendment

A recorded correction that preserves the original and identifies the change.

IN USE make a traceable amendment

holding time

The specified period allowed before a sample-related preparation or analysis step.

IN USE review the holding time

preservation

Measures specified to maintain a sample's relevant condition.

IN USE document sample preservation

Precision check

A receipt log and matching identifier provide relevant evidence, but they do not supply a missing signature. Conversely, the missing signature does not itself prove tampering, contamination, or that every result is unusable.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

field blank

A control sample used to evaluate potential contamination associated with field handling.

IN USE assess a field blank

trip blank

A control accompanying samples to assess specified transport-related contamination.

IN USE review a trip blank

equipment blank

A control used to evaluate contamination associated with sampling equipment.

IN USE examine an equipment blank

field duplicate

An additional field sample used to assess aspects of sampling and analytical variability.

IN USE compare a field duplicate

laboratory control sample

A known control used to assess laboratory analytical performance.

IN USE review a laboratory control sample

method blank

A control assessing contamination from laboratory preparation or analytical processes.

IN USE evaluate a method blank

reporting limit

A stated concentration or level below which results are not reported quantitatively under the method.

IN USE state the reporting limit

detection limit

A method-related level associated with detecting an analyte under stated conditions.

IN USE identify the detection limit

qualifier

A notation communicating a limitation or condition attached to a result.

IN USE interpret a data qualifier

data validation

A systematic evaluation of data against specified requirements.

IN USE conduct data validation

data usability

Suitability of data for a defined question or decision.

IN USE assess data usability

corrective record

Documentation of a correction or follow-up action.

IN USE retain the corrective record

Precision check

Apply the stated project requirement to this direct field-to-laboratory handoff. Do not generalize it to every common-carrier transfer. Any amendment must preserve the original and accurately identify its timing, basis, and author.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

LOCATE THE GAP

"The receiving-signature box for GW03 is blank."

PRESERVE THE EVIDENCE

"Keep the original record unchanged."

CHECK IDENTITY

"The bottle identifier matches the submission sheet."

SEPARATE RESULT AND ACCEPTANCE

"An analytical result is available; usability is still under review."

IDENTIFY THE REQUIREMENT

"Project plan P6 requires that signature for this handoff."

STATE CORROBORATING INFORMATION

"The receipt log records arrival at 16:25."

AVOID AN ACCUSATION

"We have not established why the signature is missing."

REQUEST A CLARIFICATION

"Please provide a traceable account of the handoff."

Available versus usable

A reported result may still await suitability review.

Blank box

An observation about a specific record, not an accusation.

For this handoff

Restricts the requirement to the supplied project context.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID FABRICATION

"Do not sign as though the original entry had been completed."

LIMIT THE CONCLUSION

"The gap alone does not prove that the sample was contaminated."

STATE THE INTENDED USE

"Assess suitability for the stated project question."

DOCUMENT A CORRECTION

"Identify the amendment's author, date, and evidential basis."

NAME THE REVIEWER

"Jonas will evaluate the documentation and data context."

AVOID AUTOMATIC ACCEPTANCE

"Matching labels do not resolve every quality question."

KEEP QUALIFICATIONS ATTACHED

"Carry relevant qualifiers into the report."

CLOSE THE ISSUE ACCURATELY

"The deviation remains open pending the quality review."

As though

Signals a misleading reconstruction of an earlier record.

For the stated purpose

Limits a usability conclusion to its actual decision context.

Pending review

Does not mean either accepted or rejected.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which action preserves traceability?

- A** Retain the original and request a dated, attributed clarification.
- B** Replace the original with an undated clean copy.
- C** Ask someone to imitate the missing signature.
- D** Delete the receipt log to make the records consistent.

2. Which statement is supported?

- A** A matching bottle proves the method had no error.
- B** Every unsigned transfer universally invalidates every result.
- C** The log records receipt at 16:25, but the receiving signature remains missing.
- D** The log proves every custody requirement was met.

3. What question should guide usability review?

- A** Can we make the report look complete?
- B** Can the signature be added without anyone noticing?
- C** Can all quality records be omitted?
- D** Can these data support the defined project question, given the quality evidence?

4. Which claim is an unsupported accusation?

- A** The identifier matches the submission sheet.
- B** The receipt log records 16:25.
- C** Someone tampered with GW03.
- D** A signature is missing.

Answers and explanations: [page 78](#).

Trace a missing custody signature without inventing it

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

sample identifier / deviation / data quality objective / chain of custody / Data validation / traceable amendment / corrective record / receipt log / data usability / qualifier

- 01 **Elena:** GW03 has an analytical result, but its receiving-signature box is blank. The sender signed. How should I describe this?
- 02 **Jonas:** Call it a documented ¹ _____ from project plan P6. That plan requires the laboratory custodian's signature for this direct handoff. Keep the description limited to the observed gap.
- 03 **Elena:** The laboratory log records arrival at sixteen twenty-five. The bottle identifier also matches the submission sheet sent with the sample.
- 04 **Jonas:** Include the ² _____ as supporting evidence. Those records matter, but neither the arrival entry nor matching label fills the empty signature box or ends the review.
- 05 **Elena:** A colleague suggested asking the custodian to sign the original without a note, so that the document looks complete.
- 06 **Jonas:** We need a ³ _____, not a reconstruction presented as an original entry. Preserve the record and request an attributed account of the handoff through the applicable quality process.
- 07 **Elena:** Should I tell the client that the result is invalid until we receive that account? The report deadline is approaching.
- 08 **Jonas:** Say ⁴ _____ remains under review. We have not reached a rejection or acceptance decision. A documentation gap needs evaluation in context, not a conclusion chosen to sound decisive.
- 09 **Elena:** The client may ask whether the missing signature proves that someone changed the bottle or contaminated its contents.
- 10 **Jonas:** It does not establish either allegation. Describe the ⁵ _____ gap accurately and refer the question to the review. Avoid turning missing documentation into an accusation about a person's conduct.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Elena:** Could I at least say that matching labels establish that the analytical value is correct? That seems reassuring but perhaps too broad.
- 12 **Jonas:** The matching ⁶ _____ supports identity checks. Analytical quality involves other evidence. We should not use one matching field to certify every aspect of collection, handling, preparation, and analysis.
- 13 **Elena:** I will attach the original form, receipt log, submission sheet, and any later clarification. Is the intended project decision also relevant?
- 14 **Jonas:** Yes. The ⁷ _____ helps define what the data must support. Review suitability for that question rather than treating usable as an unrestricted label for every possible application.
- 15 **Elena:** The report writer wants to remove qualification symbols because they make the table harder to read. What should I tell her?
- 16 **Jonas:** Keep each relevant ⁸ _____ attached and explain it clearly. Readability is important, but a cleaner table must not silently strip away limitations that affect interpretation of the results.
- 17 **Elena:** I will leave the issue open, send the evidence package, and ask for your review status before the report is finalized.
- 18 **Jonas:** Good. ⁹ _____ and the usability decision need their own status. The presence of a number in a laboratory report does not show that these review steps are complete.
- 19 **Elena:** My update will identify the blank receiving signature, the corroborating records, and the pending decision. It will not blame the custodian.
- 20 **Jonas:** That works. Retain the eventual ¹⁰ _____ alongside the original evidence. Once a decision is made, state its basis and any limits, rather than merely replacing pending with an unexplained approved label.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. deviation | 2. receipt log | 3. traceable amendment | 4. data usability | 5. chain of custody | 6. sample identifier | 7. data quality objective | 8. qualifier | 9. Data validation | 10. corrective record

Report another custody discrepancy

F Say it

For sample SW08, the project-required receiving signature is blank. The receipt log states 10:40. Mina owns the usability review, which is still pending.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

pending / SW08 / 10:40 / Mina

Coordinator: "The affected sample is ¹ _____."

Reviewer: "The receipt log records ² _____."

Coordinator: "The review owner is ³ _____."

Reviewer: "The usability decision remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. SW08 | 2. 10:40 | 3. Mina | 4. pending

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Clarify the requested modeling scenario

A Read the situation

Ask a bounded agency question without presenting an assumption as a requirement.

Agency comment C7 asks the Delta project team to add wet-weather modeling. The submission already includes a dry-weather baseline. Comment C7 does not state the storm duration, intensity, or return period to use. Consultant Arun thinks the agency may mean a 100-year event, but that interpretation is unconfirmed. Agency coordinator Becca will seek written clarification using the existing comment reference and a concise list of missing parameters. A response package is scheduled internally for Friday; the agency has not promised a clarification date. No revised scenario or permit approval has been issued.

PEOPLE / Arun: Modeling consultant | Becca: Agency coordinator

A PRECISE QUESTION CAN SAVE AN ENTIRE REVISION

Teams sometimes avoid clarification because they fear appearing inexperienced. State what is understood, isolate the missing parameters, and ask for confirmation. A bounded question demonstrates control of the submission without pretending that an ambiguous comment is complete.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does C7 explicitly request?

- A Additional wet-weather modeling
- C Immediate permit approval

- B A confirmed 100-year event
- D Deletion of every existing model

2. What is Arun's 100-year interpretation?

- A An unconfirmed assumption
- C An approved permit condition

- B A written agency instruction
- D A completed simulation

3. What does Friday represent?

- A Automatic approval of the dry-weather model
- C An agency-guaranteed reply date

- B An internal response-package target
- D The permit issue date

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

permit application

A request for authorization under an applicable permitting process.

IN USE submit a permit application

agency comment

A reviewing authority's documented question or requested change.

IN USE respond to an agency comment

comment-response matrix

A table linking each comment to a response and supporting material.

IN USE update the comment-response matrix

modeling scenario

A defined set of conditions evaluated in a model.

IN USE specify a modeling scenario

baseline condition

The reference condition against which alternatives are evaluated.

IN USE define the baseline condition

wet-weather event

A rainfall-related condition relevant to the assessment.

IN USE characterize a wet-weather event

dry-weather flow

Flow under the specified conditions without the modeled rainfall contribution.

IN USE estimate dry-weather flow

storm duration

The period over which a storm event is represented.

IN USE confirm the storm duration

rainfall intensity

The rate of rainfall over a specified interval.

IN USE state rainfall intensity

return period

A statistical expression of event frequency under specified assumptions.

IN USE specify the return period

annual exceedance probability

The estimated chance an event magnitude is exceeded in a given year.

IN USE explain annual exceedance probability

boundary condition

A specified condition imposed at the edge or interface of a model.

IN USE document a boundary condition

Precision check

A 100-year return period does not mean an event occurs exactly once every century. It expresses frequency statistically under stated assumptions. Here, no return period has been specified by the agency.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

model domain

The spatial or conceptual extent represented in a model.

IN USE define the model domain

input parameter

A value supplied to a model.

IN USE confirm an input parameter

calibration

Adjustment of model parameters against relevant observations.

IN USE document model calibration

sensitivity analysis

Evaluation of how outputs change when inputs or assumptions change.

IN USE conduct sensitivity analysis

submission package

The documents and data formally provided for review.

IN USE revise the submission package

review cycle

A round of submission, assessment, and response.

IN USE plan the review cycle

written clarification

A documented explanation resolving an ambiguity.

IN USE obtain written clarification

assumption register

A record of assumptions and their confirmation status.

IN USE maintain an assumption register

permit condition

A requirement attached to an issued authorization.

IN USE interpret a permit condition

technical memorandum

A focused document explaining a technical issue or analysis.

IN USE prepare a technical memorandum

response deadline

The required or agreed time for a response, as applicable.

IN USE verify the response deadline

version identifier

A label distinguishing one document or model issue from another.

IN USE retain the version identifier

Precision check

An internal Friday target is not an agency response deadline or an approval date. Record the missing parameters and the clarification request without representing a proposed model run as an agreed requirement.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

CITE THE COMMENT

"We are responding to comment C7."

STATE WHAT IS CLEAR

"The comment requests wet-weather modeling."

NAME THE EXISTING CASE

"The submission includes a dry-weather baseline."

IDENTIFY MISSING INPUTS

"The duration, intensity, and return period are unspecified."

LABEL THE INTERPRETATION

"The 100-year event is our unconfirmed interpretation."

ASK A BOUNDED QUESTION

"Please confirm the event parameters intended for C7."

AVOID ASSUMED AGREEMENT

"We have not received written clarification."

KEEP THE RECORD ORGANIZED

"Link the reply to the comment-response matrix."

Requests versus specifies

A request can establish the task while leaving parameters unresolved.

We understand

Introduces an interpretation that should remain open to confirmation.

Intended

Asks what the authority meant rather than asserting it.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

SEPARATE TARGET AND PROMISE

"Friday is our internal package target."

PROTECT ACCURACY

"Do not call a proposed scenario an agency requirement."

CLARIFY THE MODEL BOUNDARY

"Confirm whether the existing model domain remains applicable."

PRESERVE VERSIONS

"Identify which model issue the response addresses."

REPORT THE DEPENDENCY

"The revised scenario depends on clarification of these inputs."

REQUEST A USABLE RESPONSE

"A written parameter set will let us scope the revision."

AVOID APPROVAL LANGUAGE

"No permit approval has been issued."

CLOSE THE COORDINATION

"I will report the clarification status against C7."

Internal target

A planning date controlled by the team, not an agency promise.

Depends on

Names an unresolved input needed for the next step.

Issued

Refers to an actual authorization, not a predicted outcome.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which agency question is most useful?

- A** Can you approve everything now?
- B** Why was your comment so vague?
- C** We used a 100-year storm because you required it.
- D** For C7, please confirm the storm duration, intensity, and return period.

2. Which statement overstates the agency's instruction?

- A** C7 requests wet-weather modeling.
- B** The duration is unspecified.
- C** We need written clarification.
- D** C7 requires a 100-year event.

3. What should the response matrix show before clarification arrives?

- A** A claim that no additional modeling was requested
- B** The open parameter question and clarification-request status
- C** A fabricated approval date
- D** A closed comment with no response

4. What does a 100-year return period not mean?

- A** A concept distinct from storm duration
- B** Exactly one occurrence every hundred years
- C** A statistical frequency expression under stated assumptions
- D** A parameter requiring appropriate interpretation

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

Clarify the requested modeling scenario

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

comment-response matrix / version identifier / modeling scenario / response deadline / written clarification / permit condition / submission package / assumption register / model domain / return period

- 01 **Arun:** C7 asks for wet-weather modeling. I think they mean a hundred-year event, but the comment does not actually say that.
- 02 **Becca:** Then put that interpretation in the ¹ _____. Mark it unconfirmed. We should ask what the reviewer intends before describing a particular storm as a requirement.
- 03 **Arun:** The submitted model covers a dry-weather baseline. It does not include the additional rainfall case, so the request itself is understandable.
- 04 **Becca:** Agreed. Distinguish the requested ² _____ from its missing inputs. We can acknowledge the wet-weather request while asking for the duration, intensity, and return period.
- 05 **Arun:** Would a general question asking what they want be enough? I worry that a long message will slow the response.
- 06 **Becca:** Use a concise ³ _____ request tied to C7. List only the unresolved parameters and state which baseline is already included. That makes the question easier to answer.
- 07 **Arun:** I will not call the hundred-year event an agency instruction. Should I explain that return period is different from storm duration?
- 08 **Becca:** Yes, where needed. The ⁴ _____ describes statistical frequency under stated assumptions, not how long a storm lasts or a fixed interval between occurrences. Keep those terms separate.
- 09 **Arun:** Our manager wants the response package on Friday. The agency has not told us when it will provide the missing parameters.
- 10 **Becca:** Report Friday as an internal ⁵ _____ for our package, not a promised agency reply. If clarification remains outstanding, identify the dependency and the actual status rather than pretending it arrived.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Arun:** The project team also asked whether receiving a clarification would mean the permit is effectively approved. That seems like another leap.
- 12 **Becca:** It would not establish a ⁶ _____ or permit approval by itself. A clarification can define the requested analysis without deciding whether the eventual submission satisfies the permitting process.
- 13 **Arun:** I will track the request and response under C7. We need readers to find the same question across the correspondence and revised package.
- 14 **Becca:** Use the ⁷ _____ for that connection. Leave the item open until its actual response status supports a change. Do not close it merely because we sent an email.
- 15 **Arun:** There may also be a question about whether the current model boundary remains appropriate. Can we include that without introducing an entirely new assignment?
- 16 **Becca:** Ask whether the existing ⁸ _____ remains applicable to the requested scenario. Keep it a clarification question, not an assertion that the agency has ordered additional geographic coverage.
- 17 **Arun:** When the reply arrives, the modeler will need to know which existing issue it refers to. We have two internal versions.
- 18 **Becca:** Include the ⁹ _____ in the technical record. Otherwise, a correct parameter can still be applied to the wrong model issue, creating another avoidable review problem.
- 19 **Arun:** The message will identify C7, the existing baseline, the missing parameters, and our internal target. It will ask for confirmation without promising an outcome.
- 20 **Becca:** Good. Keep the ¹⁰ _____ consistent with that exchange. When we know the intended scenario, we can plan the revision and describe what remains to be reviewed.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. assumption register | 2. modeling scenario | 3. written clarification | 4. return period | 5. response deadline | 6. permit condition | 7. comment-response matrix | 8. model domain | 9. version identifier | 10. submission package

Clarify a second agency comment

F Say it

Comment C12 requests noise modeling but leaves the operating hours and receptor locations unspecified. Dev owns the clarification request. Monday is the internal package target.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

C12 / Monday / Dev / hours

Consultant: "The unresolved comment reference is ¹ _____."

Coordinator: "One missing input is the operating ² _____."

Consultant: "The clarification owner is ³ _____."

Coordinator: "The internal package target is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. C12 | 2. hours | 3. Dev | 4. Monday

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Faster implementation is not necessarily a shorter project

A Read the situation

Compare alternatives on a stated basis without choosing a technical solution from incomplete evidence.

Client representative Omar asks consultant Tess which of two preliminary remediation options is best. Option A estimates four weeks of implementation at \$120,000, followed by 12 months of monitoring at \$5,000 per month. Option B estimates two weeks of implementation at \$90,000, followed by 24 months of monitoring at the same monthly amount. All amounts are undiscounted planning estimates with no escalation or other costs included. Technical suitability, regulatory acceptability, and actual completion criteria remain unassessed. Neither option is authorized. Tess must compare the stated time and cost components without recommending a remedy from these figures alone.

PEOPLE / Omar: Client representative | Tess: Environmental consultant

REPLACE BEST WITH A DEFINED COMPARISON

A client may ask for one clear winner when the evidence supports several limited comparisons. Answer the specific cost and time questions directly, then identify the unresolved technical and acceptance criteria that prevent a complete recommendation.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which option has the lower implementation estimate?

A Both at \$90,000

B Neither has a cost estimate

C B at \$90,000

D A at \$120,000

2. What is A's stated monitoring cost?

A \$120,000

B \$180,000

C \$60,000

D \$5,000

3. What remains unresolved?

A Every implementation estimate

B The monthly monitoring amount

C Whether the options have different monitoring periods

D Technical suitability and regulatory acceptability

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

remediation

Work intended to address environmental contamination under defined objectives.

IN USE evaluate remediation options

remedial objective

A defined outcome that a remediation approach aims to achieve.

IN USE establish a remedial objective

conceptual site model

A representation of sources, pathways, receptors, and relevant site conditions.

IN USE refine the conceptual site model

source area

The location from which contamination originates or is concentrated.

IN USE characterize the source area

exposure pathway

A route linking a contaminant source to a potential receptor.

IN USE evaluate an exposure pathway

receptor

A person or ecological entity potentially exposed to a contaminant.

IN USE identify a potential receptor

contaminant of concern

A substance selected for further evaluation in the site context.

IN USE identify a contaminant of concern

feasibility

Practical suitability of an approach under the relevant conditions.

IN USE assess technical feasibility

treatability study

An investigation of how a treatment may perform for particular material or conditions.

IN USE scope a treatability study

in situ treatment

Treatment performed in place rather than after removing the affected material.

IN USE evaluate in situ treatment

ex situ treatment

Treatment of affected material after removal from its original location.

IN USE compare ex situ treatment

containment

Measures intended to limit contaminant movement or exposure.

IN USE assess a containment approach

Precision check

A totals \$180,000 and B totals \$210,000 on the stated implementation-plus-monitoring basis. These are undiscounted estimates, not complete life-cycle costs or proof that A is technically preferable.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

monitored natural attenuation

A monitored strategy relying on natural processes under appropriate evaluated conditions.

IN USE evaluate monitored natural attenuation

institutional control

A non-engineered restriction or mechanism intended to limit exposure or use.

IN USE document an institutional control

engineering control

A physical measure intended to reduce exposure or contaminant movement.

IN USE maintain an engineering control

implementation period

Time allocated to carrying out the specified installation or active work.

IN USE estimate the implementation period

monitoring period

Time during which specified conditions or performance are checked.

IN USE define the monitoring period

performance criterion

A measure used to evaluate whether an approach meets its objective.

IN USE specify a performance criterion

residual risk

Risk remaining after specified controls or actions.

IN USE evaluate residual risk

life-cycle cost

Cost across the defined stages and period of an option.

IN USE compare life-cycle costs

undiscounted estimate

An estimate that does not adjust future amounts to present value.

IN USE present an undiscounted estimate

contingency allowance

An amount reserved for specified uncertainty in a cost estimate.

IN USE define the contingency allowance

regulatory acceptability

Whether an approach meets the relevant authority's applicable expectations or requirements.

IN USE assess regulatory acceptability

completion criterion

A defined condition required to establish completion.

IN USE confirm the completion criterion

Precision check

B has a shorter estimated implementation period but a longer monitoring period. Neither the two-week nor four-week figure establishes when the whole remediation obligation ends; completion criteria remain unresolved.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

DEFINE THE QUESTION

"Best depends on the criteria we are comparing."

COMPARE THE INITIAL COMPONENT

"B has the lower implementation estimate."

ADD THE MONITORING COMPONENT

"A includes 12 months of monitoring at \$5,000 per month."

STATE THE LIMITED TOTAL

"A totals \$180,000 on this stated basis."

CONTRAST THE SECOND TOTAL

"B totals \$210,000 on the same stated basis."

NAME THE CALCULATION

"These are undiscounted planning estimates."

PRESERVE EXCLUSIONS

"No escalation or other costs are included."

SEPARATE DURATION MEASURES

"Implementation time is not the full monitoring period."

On this basis

Restricts a conclusion to included components and assumptions.

Implementation versus completion

Active work can end before monitoring or other obligations end.

Lower versus best

A numerical ranking is not a full technical recommendation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A COMPLETION PROMISE

"Two weeks does not establish project completion."

KEEP APPROVAL SEPARATE

"Neither option has been authorized."

AVOID A FALSE WINNER

"The lower stated total is not a complete recommendation."

LIMIT THE CLAIM

"This comparison addresses only the supplied components."

NAME THE UNRESOLVED EVIDENCE

"Technical suitability remains unassessed."

REQUEST THE DECISION CRITERIA

"We need the relevant performance and acceptance criteria."

EXPLAIN THE TRADE-OFF

"B starts with a lower implementation cost but more monitoring months."

CLOSE THE DISCUSSION

"Record the cost comparison and the questions requiring technical review."

Undiscounted

Future amounts are added without present-value adjustment.

Remains unassessed

States that suitability has not yet been determined.

Authorized

Requires actual permission, not preference for a preliminary estimate.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. What is B's stated combined total?

- A** \$180,000
- B** \$210,000
- C** \$90,000
- D** \$120,000

2. Which comparison is accurate?

- A** B has shorter implementation but longer monitoring.
- B** B completes every obligation in two weeks.
- C** A has no monitoring cost.
- D** Both have identical monitoring periods.

3. Which recommendation exceeds the evidence?

- A** A's limited total is \$30,000 lower.
- B** Both options need further technical assessment.
- C** The estimates exclude other costs.
- D** Select A because its lower stated total proves technical suitability.

4. What should appear beside the totals?

- A** Included components, undiscounted basis, exclusions, and unresolved criteria
- B** A guarantee that costs cannot change
- C** An assertion of regulator approval
- D** A claim that monitoring is unnecessary

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

Faster implementation is not necessarily a shorter project

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

life-cycle cost / Feasibility / monitoring period / remedial objective / performance criterion / completion criterion / implementation period / regulatory acceptability / undiscounted estimate / contingency allowance

- 01 **Omar:** B looks best: ninety thousand dollars and two weeks. Why would we choose the option costing more and taking longer?
- 02 **Tess:** Those are the ¹ _____ and its associated cost. B also has twenty-four months of monitoring. We need to compare the same components before drawing a broader conclusion.
- 03 **Omar:** A has twelve monitoring months, and both use five thousand dollars per month. What does that make the monitoring totals?
- 04 **Tess:** A's ² _____ adds sixty thousand dollars; B's adds one hundred twenty thousand. Those amounts belong beside the implementation figures, not outside the comparison merely because they occur later.
- 05 **Omar:** So A is one hundred eighty thousand overall, and B is two hundred ten thousand, assuming only these stated components.
- 06 **Tess:** Correct. Each is an ³ _____. We have not adjusted future amounts to present value or added escalation and other costs. Do not present either number as a fixed complete price.
- 07 **Omar:** That reverses the initial ranking. Could I now tell management that A is definitely the recommended solution because it costs less?
- 08 **Tess:** Not yet. ⁴ _____ remains unassessed. A lower total on this basis does not prove that A will work at the site or satisfy the relevant performance and acceptance requirements.
- 09 **Omar:** Does B's shorter implementation mean the whole project finishes earlier?
- 10 **Tess:** No. We do not have the ⁵ _____ needed to make that claim. Installation duration and overall completion are different. The longer monitoring requirement also matters when describing what follows implementation.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Omar:** I see. We need to distinguish the physical work from the subsequent checks, and avoid making the short schedule sound like final closure.
- 12 **Tess:** Exactly. A ⁶ _____ tells us what an approach must achieve. Until those requirements and the technical evidence are assessed, neither schedule is a guarantee of a successful remedy.
- 13 **Omar:** The client team also wants to know whether the regulator will accept either proposal. Do these preliminary estimates tell us that?
- 14 **Tess:** They do not establish ⁷ _____. We should name that as unresolved rather than imply acceptance. Technical suitability, authority requirements, cost, and timing are related questions, but they are not interchangeable answers.
- 15 **Omar:** How should we label the comparison table so that management still gets a useful result without mistaking it for a complete recommendation?
- 16 **Tess:** Call it the stated implementation-plus-monitoring comparison. Avoid claiming a complete ⁸ _____ assessment. Put the amounts, periods, exclusions, and unresolved criteria together where the reader can see the limits immediately.
- 17 **Omar:** Could unforeseen work change either total? We have not included a reserve or any amount for uncertain additional work in these figures.
- 18 **Tess:** Yes. No ⁹ _____ is included here. That does not mean uncertainty is absent. It means this comparison has not assigned an additional amount to it.
- 19 **Omar:** I will report A's lower stated total and B's shorter implementation, then list technical suitability, acceptance, and completion criteria as unresolved.
- 20 **Tess:** That is balanced. Keep the ¹⁰ _____ central when the qualified team develops its recommendation. Neither preliminary option is authorized simply because we have clarified the arithmetic or expressed a preference.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. implementation period | 2. monitoring period | 3. undiscounted estimate | 4. Feasibility | 5. completion criterion | 6. performance criterion | 7. regulatory acceptability | 8. life-cycle cost | 9. contingency allowance | 10. remedial objective

Compare a smaller proposal

F Say it

Option C estimates \$40,000 implementation plus six monitoring months at \$2,000 monthly. Option D estimates \$35,000 plus twelve months at \$2,000. Other costs are excluded; suitability remains unassessed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

59,000 / 52,000 / unassessed / 12,000

Consultant: "C's monitoring component is ¹ _____ dollars."

Client: "C's stated combined estimate is ² _____ dollars."

Consultant: "D's stated combined estimate is ³ _____ dollars."

Client: "Technical suitability remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. 12,000 | 2. 52,000 | 3. 59,000 | 4. unassessed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A documented action is not automatically a closed finding

A Read the situation

05

Report audit status using explicit evidence, ownership, and closure categories.

A fictional facility review has six findings, F1-F6. Four have documented corrective-action plans and assigned owners. Of those four, F1 and F2 also have verified effectiveness evidence and are closed under the local review process. F3 and F4 remain open because their effectiveness checks are pending. F5 and F6 have neither a documented action plan nor an assigned owner. Coordinator Ruby and review lead Ian must correct a dashboard that calls all four planned findings closed. Ian will secure ownership for F5 and F6; the next status review is Thursday at 15:00, not a promise that all findings will be resolved.

PEOPLE / Ruby: Compliance coordinator | Ian: Review lead

REPORT PROGRESS WITHOUT CHANGING THE DEFINITION

Teams want visible progress, and a completed plan can feel like a completed problem. Recognize the planning milestone while keeping closure tied to the stated evidence. Consistent categories make the report useful rather than pessimistic.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many findings are verified closed?

A Six

B None

C Two

D Four

2. How many findings remain open?

A Three

B Four

C Two

D Six

3. What is missing for F5 and F6?

A Only a dashboard color

B A verified closure date despite completed evidence

C Both a documented action plan and an assigned owner

D Only the original finding identifier

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

compliance obligation

An applicable requirement that an organization must meet.

IN USE identify a compliance obligation

audit scope

The defined coverage and boundaries of an audit or review.

IN USE agree the audit scope

audit criterion

A requirement or benchmark used to evaluate evidence.

IN USE identify the audit criterion

objective evidence

Verifiable information supporting a finding or conclusion.

IN USE examine objective evidence

finding

A documented result of comparing evidence with review criteria.

IN USE record a finding

nonconformity

A failure to meet a specified requirement.

IN USE document a nonconformity

observation

A noted condition whose classification depends on the review process.

IN USE record an observation

corrective-action plan

A documented proposal to address an identified problem and its cause.

IN USE approve a corrective-action plan

correction

Action addressing a detected problem or instance.

IN USE document the immediate correction

corrective action

Action aimed at removing a cause to prevent recurrence.

IN USE verify corrective action

root cause

An underlying cause relevant to preventing recurrence.

IN USE investigate the root cause

action owner

The person accountable for a specified follow-up action.

IN USE assign an action owner

Precision check

Two of six findings are closed, approximately 33.3%. Four of six have plans, approximately 66.7%. These percentages measure different states. Neither percentage alone establishes facility-wide compliance.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

target date

A planned completion or review date.

IN USE agree a target date

effectiveness check

Evaluation of whether an action achieved its intended result.

IN USE complete an effectiveness check

closure evidence

Information supporting closure under the applicable process.

IN USE retain closure evidence

open finding

A finding not yet meeting the stated closure requirements.

IN USE track an open finding

overdue action

An action not completed by its applicable due date.

IN USE escalate an overdue action

recurring finding

A finding involving a problem identified again.

IN USE investigate a recurring finding

audit trail

Records allowing actions and decisions to be traced.

IN USE preserve the audit trail

evidence register

An organized record linking evidence to review items.

IN USE update the evidence register

closure rate

The proportion of defined findings meeting the stated closure condition.

IN USE calculate the closure rate

management review

A structured leadership review of relevant performance and issues.

IN USE prepare for management review

escalation route

The defined path for raising an unresolved matter.

IN USE use the escalation route

verification status

The recorded stage of checking a claim or action.

IN USE report verification status

Precision check

A correction fixes an instance; corrective action addresses a cause to prevent recurrence. A plan for either is not proof of implementation or effectiveness. Use the local closure definition supplied in this case.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CORRECT THE HEADLINE

"Four findings have plans, but only two are closed."

NAME THE CLOSED ITEMS

"F1 and F2 have verified effectiveness evidence."

IDENTIFY THE OWNERSHIP GAP

"F5 and F6 have no assigned owner."

CALCULATE CONSISTENTLY

"The verified closure rate is two out of six."

STATE THE DENOMINATOR

"The review contains six findings in total."

DESCRIBE THE PENDING CHECKS

"F3 and F4 remain open pending effectiveness checks."

SEPARATE MILESTONES

"A documented plan is not verified closure."

LIMIT THE PERCENTAGE

"That is approximately 33.3% of this review's findings."

Have plans

Describes documentation status, not completed implementation.

Verified closed

Adds the evidence requirement supplied by this case.

Two out of six

Makes the denominator visible before giving a percentage.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PRESERVE THE REMAINING WORK

"Four findings remain open."

AVOID A FALSE DEADLINE

"Thursday at 15:00 is the status review."

DISTINGUISH ACTION TYPES

"An immediate correction does not automatically address recurrence."

PREVENT SILENT RELABELING

"Do not change the closure definition to improve the dashboard."

ASSIGN THE NEXT COORDINATION

"Ian will secure ownership for F5 and F6."

ASK FOR EVIDENCE

"Link each closure to its supporting record."

USE THE AGREED CRITERION

"Apply the local effectiveness-based closure process."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"Bring the owner updates and pending evidence to Thursday's review."

Remain open

Includes both pending checks and unassigned work.

Secure ownership

Commits to coordination, not instant resolution of the finding.

This review

Limits the conclusion to the defined scope.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which dashboard headline is accurate?

- A** Four closed because four plans exist.
- B** All six compliant because a review occurred.
- C** No progress because four findings remain open.
- D** Two closed, two awaiting effectiveness checks, two without plans or owners.

2. What is the verified closure rate?

- A** Approximately 33.3%
- B** Approximately 66.7%
- C** 100%
- D** 50%

3. What must not be inferred from Thursday's review time?

- A** All findings will be resolved by then.
- B** Ian will report ownership progress.
- C** Pending evidence will be discussed.
- D** The team will update the status.

4. Which record best supports closure in this case?

- A** A plan title alone
- B** A more positive dashboard color
- C** An unassigned reminder
- D** Verified effectiveness evidence linked to the finding

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

A documented action is not automatically a closed finding

E Conversations / turns 1-10

05

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

open finding / effectiveness check / action owner / target date / evidence register / audit scope / escalation route / closure rate / audit trail / corrective-action plan

- 01 **Ruby:** The dashboard shows four of six findings closed. I traced the count to the four corrective-action plans, but that seems wrong.
- 02 **Ian:** It is. A ¹ _____ records what is intended. Only F1 and F2 have the verified effectiveness evidence required for closure under our local process. Correct the headline.
- 03 **Ruby:** F3 and F4 have owners and plans, but their effectiveness checks are pending. They should not disappear from the open list.
- 04 **Ian:** Keep each as an ² _____. We can acknowledge the planning progress while retaining the unresolved verification. Progress and closure are different categories, and both deserve an accurate place on the dashboard.
- 05 **Ruby:** F5 and F6 are a different problem. Neither has an owner or a documented plan, so their next steps are unclear.
- 06 **Ian:** I will secure an ³ _____ for each. Until that is confirmed, do not put my name in the owner field as though the action responsibility has already been settled.
- 07 **Ruby:** You are coordinating the assignment, not necessarily taking responsibility for both corrective actions. I will show that distinction in the status note.
- 08 **Ian:** Exactly. Use the ⁴ _____ if the ownership decision remains unresolved. An empty field needs visible follow-up, but an invented owner would only make the report appear more complete.
- 09 **Ruby:** For the summary percentage, two divided by six gives approximately thirty-three point three percent. Four plans would be approximately sixty-six point seven percent.
- 10 **Ian:** Label the first ⁵ _____. Label the other as plan coverage if we include it. Do not use the larger percentage with the closure label, even if the calculation itself is correct.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

05

- 11 **Ruby:** Could a reader interpret the closure percentage as saying the whole facility is thirty-three percent compliant? That would not be our intended meaning.
- 12 **Ian:** Tie it to the ⁶ _____. It describes these six findings under this review, not the proportion of all facility obligations being met. The denominator needs a plain-language explanation.
- 13 **Ruby:** I will link F1 and F2 to the verification records. A dashboard reader should be able to locate the basis for closure.
- 14 **Ian:** Put those references in the ⁷ _____. A closed label without the supporting record is harder to check and easier to misinterpret when the next reviewer takes over.
- 15 **Ruby:** For F3 and F4, I will show the checks as pending. I will not claim that the actions failed simply because verification is incomplete.
- 16 **Ian:** Correct. An ⁸ _____ still pending is not evidence of failure or success. Preserve that distinction when discussing progress with the teams responsible for the actions.
- 17 **Ruby:** Thursday at fifteen hundred is the next status review. Should the slide call that the deadline for closing all remaining findings?
- 18 **Ian:** No. That ⁹ _____ concerns our review meeting. Bring the ownership updates and verification status. Do not turn a coordination appointment into a resolution promise that the action teams have not made.
- 19 **Ruby:** The corrected dashboard will show two closed, two awaiting effectiveness checks, and two lacking plans and owners. It will keep the six-finding denominator.
- 20 **Ian:** Good. Preserve the ¹⁰ _____ for this correction too. We want the next reader to understand why the number changed, rather than assume the underlying findings suddenly became worse.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. corrective-action plan | 2. open finding | 3. action owner | 4. escalation route | 5. closure rate | 6. audit scope | 7. evidence register | 8. effectiveness check | 9. target date | 10. audit trail

Fix another closure report

F Say it

A separate review has eight findings: three verified closed, two with plans awaiting effectiveness checks, and three with neither plans nor owners. The next status review is Monday.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Monday / 37.5% / three / five

Coordinator: "The number verified closed is ¹ _____."

Reviewer: "The number still open is ² _____."

Coordinator: "The verified closure rate is ³ _____."

Reviewer: "The next status review is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. three | 2. five | 3. 37.5% | 4. Monday

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A partial electricity estimate cannot support a company-wide claim

A Read the situation

Define emissions-reporting boundaries and replace an unsupported headline with a precise statement.

06

Sustainability analyst Ana has estimated 40 metric tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent from purchased electricity used at two offices during 2025. The calculation excludes the factory, company vehicles, purchased heat, and value-chain emissions. It has not undergone independent assurance. Communications manager Leo has drafted the headline "Our company is carbon neutral." No company-wide inventory or substantiation for that claim is available. Ana and Leo must replace the headline, name the included offices, period, and electricity source, and list the exclusions. They must not imply that omitted sources have zero emissions or that an estimate has been independently verified.

PEOPLE / Ana: Sustainability analyst | Leo: Communications manager

A NARROWER CLAIM CAN BE MORE CREDIBLE

Communications teams value simple messages, while technical teams need boundaries and qualifications. Collaborate on a clear positive description of what was actually measured. Do not treat a shorter headline as permission to remove the scope that makes the statement true.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the 40-tonne estimate cover?

A Purchased electricity at two offices during 2025

C All factory emissions

B The entire company and value chain

D Only emissions from company vehicles

2. Which headline is unsupported?

A Our company is carbon neutral.

C The calculation excludes the factory.

B We estimated electricity-related emissions for two offices.

D Independent assurance has not been completed.

3. What must not be inferred from excluded sources?

A The inventory is incomplete for a company-wide claim.

C Their emissions are zero.

B More work is needed to assess the broader footprint.

D They are outside this calculation.

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

greenhouse gas (GHG)

A gas that contributes to the atmosphere's heat-trapping effect.

IN USE quantify greenhouse gas emissions

carbon dioxide equivalent (CO₂e)

A common unit expressing different gases using a specified warming-potential basis.

IN USE report tonnes of CO₂e

emissions inventory

An accounting of emissions within defined boundaries and a period.

IN USE compile an emissions inventory

organizational boundary

The operations included under the chosen organizational accounting approach.

IN USE define the organizational boundary

operational boundary

The categories of emissions included in an inventory.

IN USE describe the operational boundary

Scope 1

Direct emissions from sources owned or controlled within the inventory boundary.

IN USE report Scope 1 emissions

Scope 2

Indirect emissions from generation of purchased or acquired energy consumed by the organization.

IN USE calculate Scope 2 emissions

Scope 3

Other indirect value-chain emissions within the applicable accounting framework.

IN USE assess Scope 3 categories

purchased electricity

Electricity obtained from an external supplier for consumption.

IN USE quantify purchased electricity use

purchased heat

Heat acquired from an external source for use.

IN USE account for purchased heat

value chain

Activities upstream and downstream associated with an organization's products or operations.

IN USE map the value chain

activity data

Measured or estimated activity used in calculating emissions.

IN USE collect activity data

Precision check

Scope 2 is not limited to electricity: it can include purchased or acquired steam, heat, and cooling. This case includes only electricity at two offices, not the entire company or all Scope 2 sources.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

emission factor

A coefficient relating an activity to an emissions quantity.

IN USE document the emission factor

global warming potential (GWP)

A measure comparing a gas's warming effect over a specified time horizon.

IN USE state the GWP basis

reporting year

The period assigned to an emissions or sustainability report.

IN USE specify the reporting year

base year

A reference year used for a defined comparison or target.

IN USE establish a base year

location-based method

A Scope 2 method reflecting average emissions associated with the relevant grids.

IN USE describe the location-based method

market-based method

A Scope 2 method using applicable contractual instruments under relevant criteria.

IN USE document the market-based method

assurance

An independent evaluation of reported information under an agreed engagement.

IN USE obtain independent assurance

reporting boundary

The defined extent of what a report includes.

IN USE disclose the reporting boundary

carbon-neutrality claim

An assertion about balancing or neutralizing emissions under a specified substantiated basis.

IN USE substantiate a carbon-neutrality claim

avoided emissions

Estimated emissions not occurring relative to a specified counterfactual.

IN USE distinguish avoided emissions

carbon credit

A unit representing a specified quantified emissions reduction or removal under a program.

IN USE examine carbon credit documentation

retirement

The recorded use of a credit that removes it from further use under its registry rules.

IN USE verify credit retirement

Precision check

CO₂e aggregates gases using a specified warming-potential basis. It is not the same as electricity consumption. An inventory figure, an avoided-emissions estimate, and a carbon credit are different quantities that cannot simply replace one another.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE MEASURED ACTIVITY

"The estimate covers purchased electricity at two offices."

GIVE THE CORRECT UNIT

"The estimate is 40 metric tonnes of CO₂e."

CORRECT THE HEADLINE

"The evidence does not support a carbon-neutrality claim."

AVOID A ZERO ASSUMPTION

"Excluded does not mean zero emissions."

STATE THE REPORTING PERIOD

"The reporting year is 2025."

LIMIT THE BOUNDARY

"This is not a company-wide emissions inventory."

PRESERVE EXCLUSIONS

"The factory, vehicles, purchased heat, and value chain are excluded."

STATE ASSURANCE STATUS

"Independent assurance has not been completed."

Estimated

Signals a calculated result without implying independent verification.

At two offices

Restricts the organizational coverage of this calculation.

Company-wide

A broader boundary that this evidence does not support.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

EXPLAIN SCOPE 2 CAREFULLY

"Purchased energy categories extend beyond electricity."

SEPARATE THE QUANTITIES

"Electricity use and CO₂e are different measures."

PROTECT THE CLAIM

"Keep the boundary beside the reported figure."

ASK FOR SUBSTANTIATION

"What evidence supports the proposed public claim?"

KEEP METHODS VISIBLE

"Document the calculation method and emission factors."

AVOID UNSUPPORTED COMPARISONS

"We have not established a comparable base year."

AVOID SUBSTITUTION

"A credit purchase is not a complete emissions inventory."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"Publish the limited estimate with its period, boundary, and qualifications."

06

Excluded

Describes omission, not the amount emitted.

Assured versus prepared

Independent evaluation is different from producing the calculation.

CO₂e versus kWh

Emissions units and electricity-consumption units answer different questions.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which replacement headline is supported?

- A** Factory and fleet emissions confirmed as zero.
- B** Estimated 2025 purchased-electricity emissions for two offices: 40 tonnes CO₂e.
- C** Company-wide emissions eliminated.
- D** All Scope 2 sources independently verified.

2. Which statement about Scope 2 is accurate?

- A** It can include purchased heat, steam, and cooling as well as electricity.
- B** It always means only office electricity.
- C** It means every value-chain emission.
- D** It excludes all acquired energy.

3. What does lack of independent assurance mean here?

- A** All emissions are therefore zero.
- B** The company is automatically carbon neutral.
- C** The estimate must not be described as independently assured.
- D** The number is automatically proven false.

4. Which question addresses the headline's main defect?

- A** Does the evidence cover and substantiate the company-wide claim?
- B** Can the number be printed in a larger font?
- C** Can excluded sources be called zero without calculation?
- D** Can the year be removed to shorten the sentence?

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

A partial electricity estimate cannot support a company-wide claim

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

reporting boundary / Scope 3 / carbon credit / emission factor / Assurance / Scope 1 / base year / Scope 2 / CO2e / emissions inventory

- 01 **Leo:** The headline says our company is carbon neutral. I assumed the forty-tonne estimate covered the whole footprint.
- 02 **Ana:** It is a limited ¹ _____ calculation for purchased electricity at two offices in 2025. It excludes the factory, vehicles, purchased heat, and value chain. That headline is unsupported.
- 03 **Leo:** The number is not necessarily wrong. My wording assigns it a broader meaning than the calculation supports.
- 04 **Ana:** Exactly. Keep the ² _____ beside the number. We can communicate the estimate clearly without claiming that every operation or every relevant emissions source has been included.
- 05 **Leo:** I will name the two offices and year. The unit is tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent, not kilowatt-hours of electricity consumed.
- 06 **Ana:** Correct. ³ _____ is the emissions unit. Electricity consumption is activity data used in the calculation, alongside the applicable factors and method. Keep those quantities distinct in the table and headline.
- 07 **Leo:** Can I say we have completed Scope 2 reporting? I thought Scope 2 was simply purchased electricity, which is what this file calculates.
- 08 **Ana:** ⁴ _____ can include purchased steam, heat, and cooling as well as electricity. This file covers only two offices and excludes purchased heat. Do not describe it as complete company-wide Scope 2 reporting.
- 09 **Leo:** The excluded factory and company vehicles must remain visible. Otherwise a reader could assume they were checked and contributed no emissions.
- 10 **Ana:** Yes. Relevant direct sources may fall within ⁵ _____, depending on the organizational boundary. Excluding a source from this calculation says nothing by itself about whether that source emits zero, forty, or any other amount.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Leo:** What about suppliers and customer use? Those are not included either, so our statement should not imply that we measured them.
- 12 **Ana:** Keep the relevant ⁶ _____ boundary explicit. The applicable categories require their own assessment. A two-office electricity figure cannot stand in for upstream and downstream emissions simply because it is the number currently available.
- 13 **Leo:** The team prepared the estimate internally. I have no independent assurance report. Should I describe the figure as verified to make the wording confident?
- 14 **Ana:** No. ⁷ _____ has not been completed. Say estimated and give the calculation boundary. Accurate confidence comes from describing what we have, not borrowing a status the evidence does not support.
- 15 **Leo:** Someone suggested purchasing forty credits and retaining the carbon-neutral headline. We have no company-wide inventory or substantiation package for that claim.
- 16 **Ana:** A ⁸ _____ purchase would not repair the missing boundary or establish the whole claim. Its quality, use, and relevant claim requirements would need their own evidence and review.
- 17 **Leo:** Could we compare this estimate with last year instead? I do not have a matching calculation for the same two offices and methodology.
- 18 **Ana:** Then do not invent a ⁹ _____ comparison. A reduction claim needs a comparable basis and supporting data. We can report the current limited estimate without claiming a trend that has not been established.
- 19 **Leo:** The revised headline will state estimated 2025 purchased-electricity emissions for two offices: forty metric tonnes of CO₂e. The exclusions will appear immediately below.
- 20 **Ana:** Good. Keep the ¹⁰ _____ and method documentation traceable in the supporting material. That gives readers a precise statement and reviewers a basis to examine, without implying company-wide neutrality or independent assurance.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. emissions inventory | 2. reporting boundary | 3. CO₂e | 4. Scope 2 | 5. Scope 1 | 6. Scope 3 | 7. Assurance | 8. carbon credit | 9. base year | 10. emission factor

Narrow another emissions headline

F Say it

A calculation estimates 12 tonnes CO₂e from purchased electricity at one warehouse in 2024. Fuel use and transport are excluded. Independent assurance has not been completed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

2024 / 12 / warehouse / not

Analyst: "The estimated emissions are ¹ _____ tonnes CO₂e."

Editor: "The included location is one ² _____."

Analyst: "The reporting year is ³ _____."

Editor: "Independent assurance has ⁴ _____ been completed."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. 12 | 2. warehouse | 3. 2024 | 4. not

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Answer a safety question without extending the evidence

A Read the situation

Acknowledge residents and explain preliminary results in plain language with precise boundaries.

Consultant Suki and community representative Daniel are preparing a public meeting about a fictional environmental study. Preliminary laboratory results cover water samples from locations S1, S2, and S3 collected on one June morning and tested for the listed analytes. For analyte X, each result is below the laboratory reporting limit. Other locations, other dates, and unlisted substances are outside these results. The study has not established area-wide safety or a drinking-water determination. Suki will explain these limits, record questions, and direct requests for current health or water-use advice to the responsible public authority without inventing advice.

PEOPLE / Daniel: Community representative | Suki: Environmental consultant

07

ANSWER THE HUMAN QUESTION AS WELL AS THE TECHNICAL ONE

Residents are asking about daily decisions, not merely laboratory vocabulary. Acknowledge that practical concern before explaining the evidence. Avoid using uncertainty as a reason to withdraw from the conversation or using reassurance as a substitute for a qualified answer.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the sampling cover?

A Every substance in the area

B All drinking-water decisions

C Three locations on one June morning

D Every location in every season

2. What does below the reporting limit establish?

A Every substance is absent.

B X is proven to be exactly zero everywhere.

C The laboratory did not report a quantitative value at or above that limit for X.

D The entire area is safe.

3. Where should requests for current health or water-use advice go?

A The responsible public authority

B An invented rule from the consultant

C A guess based on one chart

D A guarantee from the meeting audience

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

stakeholder

A person or group affected by or interested in a project.

IN USE engage a stakeholder

community liaison

A contact connecting a project team with affected community members.

IN USE appoint a community liaison

public meeting

A gathering for sharing information and receiving public questions.

IN USE prepare a public meeting

sampling location

The place where a sample was collected.

IN USE identify the sampling location

sampling event

A defined occasion or period of sample collection.

IN USE describe the sampling event

analyte

A substance or property targeted by an analysis.

IN USE list the target analytes

preliminary result

A result not yet at the final review or reporting stage.

IN USE qualify a preliminary result

non-detect

A result indicating an analyte was not detected at the stated analytical threshold.

IN USE explain a non-detect

quantitation

Determination of an amount or concentration under the method's conditions.

IN USE describe the quantitation limit

screening level

A comparison value used to identify matters needing further evaluation.

IN USE interpret a screening level

cleanup level

An applicable concentration or criterion used in a defined cleanup context.

IN USE identify the applicable cleanup level

exposure assessment

Evaluation of how, how much, and under what conditions exposure may occur.

IN USE conduct an exposure assessment

Precision check

Below the reporting limit does not mean zero. It also does not describe untested substances, places, or dates. Distinguish the laboratory statement from a conclusion about health or allowable water use.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

spatial coverage

The geographic extent represented by the data.

IN USE explain spatial coverage

temporal coverage

The period or times represented by the data.

IN USE explain temporal coverage

representativeness

The extent to which data reflect the conditions relevant to a question.

IN USE evaluate representativeness

uncertainty

A limitation in knowledge or confidence about a result or inference.

IN USE communicate uncertainty

risk communication

Exchange of information about risks, evidence, and relevant uncertainties.

IN USE improve risk communication

plain-language summary

An account using accessible words while preserving the meaning.

IN USE prepare a plain-language summary

question log

A record of questions and their follow-up status.

IN USE maintain a question log

responsible authority

The body with the relevant responsibility for the matter.

IN USE contact the responsible authority

public advisory

An official notice giving relevant information or guidance to the public.

IN USE check the current public advisory

meeting record

Documentation of discussion, questions, and commitments.

IN USE circulate the meeting record

follow-up contact

A named person or channel for subsequent communication.

IN USE provide a follow-up contact

area-wide claim

A statement applied to an entire geographic area.

IN USE qualify an area-wide claim

Precision check

A screening level identifies a need for further evaluation in context; it is not automatically a cleanup standard or a universal safe/unsafe boundary. This fictional case supplies no threshold for a health determination.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONCERN

"I understand that you need information for everyday decisions."

NAME THE TESTED SUBSTANCE

"This statement concerns analyte X."

AVOID AN ABSENCE CLAIM

"Below the limit does not mean proven zero."

LIMIT THE GEOGRAPHY

"We cannot extend them to every location in the area."

STATE THE SAMPLING COVERAGE

"These results cover S1, S2, and S3 on one June morning."

EXPLAIN THE RESULT

"X was below the laboratory reporting limit in these samples."

PRESERVE THE STAGE

"These results are preliminary."

LIMIT THE TIME

"One sampling event does not represent every season."

These samples

Keeps a statement attached to its actual evidence.

Below the limit

Does not mean absent, harmless, or unmeasurable by every method.

Preliminary

Names the reporting stage without declaring the result false.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP UNTESTED SUBSTANCES SEPARATE

"The report does not characterize substances that were not analyzed."

ANSWER RESPECTFULLY

"That is a reasonable question, but these results do not answer it fully."

AVOID INVENTING GUIDANCE

"I will not create a drinking-water instruction from this chart."

PROVIDE CONTINUITY

"The meeting record will identify the follow-up contact."

AVOID A HEALTH GUARANTEE

"This study has not established an area-wide safety determination."

REFER THE ADVICE QUESTION

"Please consult the responsible public authority for current water-use advice."

RECORD THE QUESTION

"We will include that request in the question log."

CLOSE WITH THE EVIDENCE

"We will distinguish the measured findings from the questions still open."

Everywhere and always

Expand spatial and temporal coverage beyond this study.

Current advice

Requires the responsible authority's actual guidance, not a guessed instruction.

Does not answer fully

Acknowledges a relevant question without manufacturing certainty.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which public statement is accurate?

- A** X was below the reporting limit in these three preliminary samples.
- B** X is absent from the entire area.
- C** Every water source is safe to drink.
- D** No further question is possible anywhere.

2. Which phrase improperly expands time coverage?

- A** Other dates are outside these results.
- B** The area is safe in every season.
- C** The samples were collected on one June morning.
- D** This is one sampling event.

3. How should Suki respond to a drinking-water question?

- A** Acknowledge the concern and refer current advice to the responsible authority.
- B** Invent a rule from the below-limit result.
- C** Guarantee safety because three samples exist.
- D** Refuse to record the question because it is inconvenient.

4. Which comparison is correct?

- A** A below-limit result replaces an exposure assessment.
- B** Screening levels and cleanup levels serve different purposes.
- C** Every screening value is automatically a cleanup standard.
- D** A screening exceedance proves a specific health outcome.

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

Answer a safety question without extending the evidence

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

preliminary result / risk communication / temporal coverage / spatial coverage / responsible authority / screening level / analyte / plain-language summary / question log / follow-up contact

07

- 01 **Daniel:** Residents will ask whether the results prove the whole area is safe. They need to know what this means for their families.
- 02 **Suki:** I understand that concern. Start with the actual ¹ _____: locations S1, S2, and S3. We should not imply that these three points represent every location or every possible exposure in the area.
- 03 **Daniel:** The chart shows X below the reporting limit at all three locations. Some readers will interpret that as no X anywhere.
- 04 **Suki:** Explain the ² _____ and the limit together. The laboratory did not report a quantitative value at or above its reporting limit for X in these samples. That is not proof of zero.
- 05 **Daniel:** Would calling it a clean result be simpler? A string of qualifications could sound evasive.
- 06 **Suki:** Use a ³ _____, but avoid clean as a blanket label. Say what was tested, where, and when. Then explain that the result does not establish conditions at untested locations or for unlisted substances.
- 07 **Daniel:** We should name the June collection date. Otherwise the chart could appear to describe the whole year.
- 08 **Suki:** Exactly. The ⁴ _____ is limited. One sampling event does not show seasonal variation or every later condition. A clear date helps readers understand what the study actually observed.
- 09 **Daniel:** If someone asks whether they can drink water from a particular source, can we answer from these results alone?
- 10 **Suki:** No. We need to identify the ⁵ _____ for current health or water-use advice. These preliminary study results have not established a drinking-water determination. We must not improvise one during the meeting.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

07

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Daniel:** I want that referral to sound helpful rather than like passing the question away. Residents deserve a clear route to an answer.
- 12 **Suki:** Provide the appropriate ⁶ _____ and record the question. Explain why the study does not answer it, and distinguish that limitation from unwillingness to listen or help them locate the relevant guidance.
- 13 **Daniel:** Someone may bring a screening-level table from another report. Should we tell them any number below that table is automatically safe?
- 14 **Suki:** No. A ⁷ _____ has a defined purpose and assumptions. It is not automatically a cleanup standard or a universal dividing line between safe and unsafe for every place, substance, and exposure.
- 15 **Daniel:** The meeting materials should also make clear that the results are preliminary. Does that mean we should avoid discussing them at all?
- 16 **Suki:** We can discuss each ⁸ _____ accurately. State the stage and limitations, and avoid final claims it cannot support. Withholding every explanation would leave readers to supply their own, possibly broader interpretation.
- 17 **Daniel:** I will organize the questions by topic and identify which ones the study can answer and which need a separate response.
- 18 **Suki:** Maintain a ⁹ _____ with the follow-up status. Do not mark a question answered merely because someone spoke about a related issue. The record should show the actual response or remaining need.
- 19 **Daniel:** Our closing message will give the three locations, one June morning, listed analytes, below-limit result for X, and the limits on wider conclusions.
- 20 **Suki:** Good. Keep ¹⁰ _____ both precise and respectful. We can acknowledge the practical concern, explain the evidence, and provide a route for further advice without claiming that this limited dataset establishes area-wide safety.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. spatial coverage | 2. analyte | 3. plain-language summary | 4. temporal coverage | 5. responsible authority | 6. follow-up contact | 7. screening level | 8. preliminary result | 9. question log | 10. risk communication

Limit another public summary

F Say it

A preliminary soil report covers locations P1 and P2 sampled on 8 May. It reports analyte Y only. The report does not characterize other locations, dates, or substances.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

preliminary / two / Y / 8 May

Consultant: "The report covers ¹ _____ locations."

Resident: "The collection date was ² _____."

Consultant: "The reported analyte is ³ _____."

Resident: "The results are still ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. two | 2. 8 May | 3. Y | 4. preliminary

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Price the additional work before promising its delivery

A Read the situation

Clarify a change request, distinguish locations from samples, and negotiate a documented next step.

The signed assignment covers six sampling locations during one site visit, followed by the agreed laboratory work and report. Client manager Grace requests four additional locations and a second visit. Project manager Malik has not assessed the additional methods, sample quantities, laboratory work, access requirements, cost, or schedule. Under this fictional agreement, additional field work requires a written approved change before it starts. Malik will provide a change-estimate status on Wednesday at 12:00; that is not a field-visit or report-delivery commitment. The existing six-location scope remains unchanged unless the parties approve a change.

PEOPLE / Grace: Client manager | Malik: Project manager

08

COOPERATION DOES NOT REQUIRE AN INSTANT PROMISE

A client may hear a scope boundary as resistance. Acknowledge the request, identify the concrete information needed to price it, and give a useful next contact. Keep willingness to assess the change separate from authorization or a delivery guarantee.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the existing agreement cover?

- A Unlimited sampling whenever requested
- C Six locations during one visit, with agreed laboratory work and report

- B Only a proposal with no defined locations
- D Ten locations across two approved visits

2. What is requested as additional work?

- A Four more locations and a second visit
- C Elimination of laboratory analysis

- B Four fewer locations
- D Immediate acceptance of a final report

3. What does Wednesday at 12:00 represent?

- A A change-estimate status update
- C Guaranteed final report delivery

- B A confirmed field start
- D Automatic change approval

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

scope of work

The agreed tasks, boundaries, and deliverables of an assignment.

IN USE define the scope of work

deliverable

A specified output supplied under an agreement.

IN USE confirm the deliverable

assumption

A condition used in planning that needs appropriate confirmation.

IN USE document a pricing assumption

exclusion

Work or cost explicitly outside an agreed scope or estimate.

IN USE state the exclusion

change request

A proposed modification to agreed work.

IN USE assess a change request

change authorization

Approval permitting a defined modification under the applicable agreement.

IN USE obtain change authorization

additional service

Work beyond the existing agreed services.

IN USE price an additional service

fee estimate

A projected charge based on stated work and assumptions.

IN USE prepare a fee estimate

cost breakdown

An allocation of a total estimate into named components.

IN USE provide a cost breakdown

mobilization

Preparing and moving resources to begin field activity.

IN USE estimate mobilization costs

demobilization

Removing resources and closing out field presence after activity.

IN USE account for demobilization

site access

Permission and practical arrangements for entering a location.

IN USE confirm site access

08

Precision check

Six existing locations plus four requested locations would make ten locations if approved. That does not automatically mean ten samples: the sampling design, controls, depths, and analytical requirements determine the sample count.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

sample count

The number of samples specified for collection or analysis.

IN USE verify the sample count

analytical suite

The set of tests or analytes included in an analytical assignment.

IN USE define the analytical suite

laboratory turnaround

The specified or estimated time for laboratory completion under stated conditions.

IN USE confirm laboratory turnaround

reporting allowance

Planned time or resources for preparing and reviewing the report.

IN USE include a reporting allowance

dependency

An input or event needed before another step can proceed.

IN USE identify a schedule dependency

lead time

The period needed before a resource, service, or activity is available.

IN USE check the lead time

schedule impact

The effect of a proposed change on planned timing.

IN USE assess the schedule impact

not-to-exceed amount

A stated spending limit subject to the agreement's terms and scope.

IN USE confirm the not-to-exceed amount

acceptance condition

A requirement used to determine whether a deliverable is accepted.

IN USE define the acceptance condition

work order

A document authorizing or specifying work under the relevant arrangement.

IN USE issue a work order

commercial review

Evaluation of proposed scope, price, and contractual terms.

IN USE complete commercial review

client sign-off

Documented client approval under the applicable process.

IN USE obtain client sign-off

08

Precision check

Laboratory turnaround is only one schedule component. Access, mobilization, collection, review, and reporting may also matter. Wednesday at 12:00 is a status-update commitment, not a promise that those dependencies will be resolved.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE REQUEST

"You are requesting four additional locations and a second visit."

SEPARATE WILLINGNESS AND APPROVAL

"We can assess the request; it is not yet authorized."

IDENTIFY THE NEEDED DETAIL

"We need the methods, sample quantities, and analytical requirements."

NAME THE COMMERCIAL STEP

"We will assess the additional cost and schedule."

RESTATE THE AGREEMENT

"The current scope covers six locations during one visit."

CLARIFY QUANTITIES

"Ten locations would not automatically mean ten samples."

KEEP ACCESS VISIBLE

"The second visit also depends on site-access arrangements."

AVOID A FREE-WORK ASSUMPTION

"Additional work is not included merely because it is discussed."

08

Would if approved

Describes a conditional expanded scope, not an existing commitment.

Locations versus samples

Different units that must not be counted interchangeably.

Can assess

Expresses willingness to evaluate, not authorization to perform.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

STATE THE LOCAL CONDITION

"This agreement requires an approved written change before extra field work."

LIMIT THAT COMMITMENT

"That is not a field-start or report-delivery date."

PRESERVE THE CURRENT SCOPE

"The existing six-location assignment remains unchanged."

RECORD THE BASIS

"The estimate will state its assumptions and exclusions."

GIVE THE NEXT COMMITMENT

"I will provide an estimate-status update Wednesday at 12:00."

SEPARATE TIMING COMPONENTS

"Laboratory turnaround is not the complete project schedule."

REQUEST AN EXPLICIT DECISION

"The change proposal will need client sign-off."

CLOSE CONSTRUCTIVELY

"I will bring the cost, timing, and open dependencies together for review."

08

Before extra work

States the supplied agreement's condition, not a universal contract rule.

Status update

A communication commitment rather than a delivery promise.

Remains unchanged

Protects the original agreement while a proposal is considered.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. If the request is approved, how many locations would be included?

- A Exactly ten samples in every case
- B Four locations in total
- C Twelve automatically approved locations
- D Ten locations, with sample count still to be determined

2. Which reply is cooperative and accurate?

- A We can assess the extra work and provide estimate status Wednesday at noon.
- B We will start the extra visit tomorrow at no charge.
- C The change is already approved because you asked.
- D Laboratory turnaround guarantees the final report date.

3. What is required before extra field work under this agreement?

- A A preferred date in a draft estimate
- B An approved written change
- C A casual mention in a meeting
- D An assumed approval from silence

4. Which schedule statement is unsupported?

- A The laboratory turnaround equals the full report-delivery period.
- B Site access is an unresolved dependency.
- C The added visit needs schedule assessment.
- D The estimate update is due Wednesday at noon.

Answers and explanations: page 90.

Price the additional work before promising its delivery

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

cost breakdown / analytical suite / fee estimate / change authorization / sample count / scope of work / Laboratory turnaround / site access / change request / client sign-off

08

- 01 **Grace:** We need four more locations and a second visit. Can your team add those to the assignment and keep the existing report date?
- 02 **Malik:** We can assess that ¹ _____. The signed scope currently covers six locations in one visit. We have not yet assessed the added work, cost, access, or schedule impact.
- 03 **Grace:** I thought four extra locations would simply mean four extra samples. Would that make ten samples altogether once we add them?
- 04 **Malik:** It would make ten locations if approved, but the ² _____ remains to be determined. Methods, depths, quality controls, and analytical needs can affect the number. We should not price an unsupported quantity.
- 05 **Grace:** I can explain the request and provide the access contact. What else does the estimate need?
- 06 **Malik:** We need the proposed ³ _____ and relevant methods, along with the sample quantities and field arrangements. The estimate should state those assumptions so you can see exactly what it covers.
- 07 **Grace:** The site contact has not confirmed entry for the second visit. I would prefer not to hold up the entire discussion while that is checked.
- 08 **Malik:** We can develop the proposal while recording ⁴ _____ as an unresolved dependency. We cannot turn a preferred visit date into a confirmed field commitment before the necessary arrangements and authorization are in place.
- 09 **Grace:** Can you update me Wednesday at noon? I have a budget discussion that afternoon.
- 10 **Malik:** I can provide the ⁵ _____ status then. If inputs remain outstanding, I will identify them clearly. That is a communication commitment, not a guarantee that the added visit or final report happens that day.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Grace:** That distinction is fine. Please show the extra field work and laboratory costs separately, so the budget reviewer understands what changes.
- 12 **Malik:** I will provide a ⁶ _____ with the assumptions and exclusions. A single unexplained total would make it harder to identify whether the proposed work matches your request or whether anything important remains omitted.
- 13 **Grace:** If the laboratory offers a five-day turnaround, can we tell our internal team that the final report will arrive five days after approval?
- 14 **Malik:** No. ⁷ _____ is only one component. We also need to consider access, mobilization, collection, review, and report preparation. Its starting point and conditions must be confirmed rather than assumed.
- 15 **Grace:** I do not want the team to lose a possible field date while paperwork circulates. Does today's discussion authorize them to reserve and perform the visit?
- 16 **Malik:** It does not provide ⁸ _____. Under this agreement, extra field work requires an approved written change before it starts. We can discuss availability without representing the work itself as authorized.
- 17 **Grace:** Please keep the existing assignment clear. The original six locations have not been cancelled.
- 18 **Malik:** The current ⁹ _____ remains unchanged. We will identify the proposed additions separately and assess their interaction with the existing schedule. Nothing in this request automatically cancels the original assignment.
- 19 **Grace:** Then Wednesday's update will cover estimate status, open inputs, and timing questions. Once the written proposal is ready, I will arrange the approval review.
- 20 **Malik:** Agreed. Obtain the required ¹⁰ _____ through the stated process before additional work proceeds. We can be responsive while keeping the quantities, costs, dependencies, and authorization status visible to both teams.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. change request | 2. sample count | 3. analytical suite | 4. site access | 5. fee estimate | 6. cost breakdown | 7. Laboratory turnaround | 8. change authorization | 9. scope of work | 10. client sign-off

Confirm a smaller scope change

F Say it

A current agreement covers five locations in one visit. The client requests three additional locations and a second visit. Sample count is unresolved, and an approved written change is required before extra field work.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

second / unresolved / change / eight

Manager: "The proposed expanded scope would cover ¹ _____ locations."

Client: "The requested visit would be the ² _____ visit."

Manager: "The sample count is still ³ _____."

Client: "Before extra field work, we need an approved written ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. eight | 2. second | 3. unresolved | 4. change

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Phase I and Phase II Site Assessments

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Which information is missing?

B. The tank-closure record

The brief identifies one outstanding tank-closure record, not an absence of all assessment work.

2. What is authorized now?

B. The current Phase I scope, without sampling

The stated scope excludes sampling, and no Phase II investigation has been authorized.

3. What is promised for Tuesday at 14:00?

B. A status update

Maya commits to reporting status, not to controlling the archive or completing additional investigation.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which summary is supported?

C. The tank-closure record remains outstanding, and its significance requires review.

The accurate summary names the missing source and preserves the unresolved professional assessment.

2. Who assesses the gap's significance?

C. Eric in the environmental-professional role

Eric holds the stated professional-review role; commercial pressure does not replace that assessment.

3. Which statement improperly broadens the scope?

C. Sampling is already authorized under this Phase I assignment.

The brief excludes sampling from the current scope and provides no further investigation authorization.

4. What should Maya report if the record is still missing on Tuesday?

A. The outstanding status and the continuing review limitation

The update commitment remains valid even if the requested source is still unavailable.

01 Conversation answers

Phase I and Phase II Site Assessments

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. data gap. Turn 2. Data gap identifies missing relevant information without deciding its significance or proving an environmental condition.

2. release. Turn 4. A release concerns a substance escaping into the environment, not merely an absent administrative record.

3. follow-up request. Turn 6. The follow-up request traces the effort to obtain missing information without treating the request as successful receipt.

4. professional opinion. Turn 8. The professional opinion evaluates the evidence and the gap's significance; emphasis alone cannot supply that assessment.

5. scope of inquiry. Turn 10. The scope of inquiry defines the existing assessment work; it does not automatically expand when a question remains unresolved.

6. executive summary. Turn 12. The executive summary should communicate both major findings and material qualifications instead of replacing them with blanket reassurance.

7. source limitation. Turn 14. The source limitation concerns the outstanding record; it does not automatically invalidate every other source or completed assessment step.

8. authorization. Turn 16. Authorization permits specified work; a communication deadline neither authorizes sampling nor determines the investigation outcome.

9. records review. Turn 18. Records review examines documentary evidence; an incomplete source set must be described accurately rather than treated as a definitive site finding.

10. subject property. Turn 20. Subject property identifies the actual site under assessment, so qualifications are not silently expanded into claims about other properties.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. solvent-storage

Consultant: "The outstanding source is the solvent-storage record."

The supplied case identifies the solvent-storage record, not a tank document.

2. Nora

Reviewer: "The person assessing significance is Nora."

Nora is explicitly assigned the significance review in this separate case.

3. sampling

Consultant: "The present assignment excludes sampling."

Sampling is outside the stated scope and cannot be presented as authorized.

4. Friday at 11:00

Reviewer: "The archive status update is due Friday at 11:00."

The stated time concerns a status update rather than guaranteed source receipt.

02 Briefing and language checks

Sampling Plans and Data Quality

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What is missing?

C. The laboratory custodian's receiving signature

The receiving-signature box is blank, while the other named information is available.

2. What does the receipt log establish in this case?

B. Recorded laboratory arrival at 16:25

The log provides a recorded arrival time but does not replace the missing signature or quality review.

3. What is the correct current data status?

B. Usability remains under review.

Jonas has not decided usability, so neither automatic rejection nor unrestricted acceptance is supported.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which action preserves traceability?

A. Retain the original and request a dated, attributed clarification.

A traceable clarification preserves the original and identifies the later explanation rather than concealing the gap.

2. Which statement is supported?

C. The log records receipt at 16:25, but the receiving signature remains missing.

The accurate statement combines the available record with its unresolved documentation limitation.

3. What question should guide usability review?

D. Can these data support the defined project question, given the quality evidence?

Data usability concerns a defined purpose and the relevant evidence, not cosmetic completeness.

4. Which claim is an unsupported accusation?

C. Someone tampered with GW03.

No supplied evidence establishes tampering; the missing signature requires investigation rather than accusation.

02 Conversation answers

Sampling Plans and Data Quality

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. deviation.** Turn 2. Deviation names the departure from this project's signature requirement without inventing why it happened.
- 2. receipt log.** Turn 4. The receipt log supplies recorded arrival evidence but does not recreate the missing receiving signature.
- 3. traceable amendment.** Turn 6. A traceable amendment preserves the original and identifies the later correction, author, timing, and basis.
- 4. data usability.** Turn 8. Data usability concerns whether evidence can support the defined project question; its review is not automatic rejection.
- 5. chain of custody.** Turn 10. Chain of custody documents sample possession and transfers; a gap prompts review without itself proving tampering.
- 6. sample identifier.** Turn 12. The sample identifier links the bottle to its records; it does not establish analytical accuracy by itself.
- 7. data quality objective.** Turn 14. The data quality objective specifies what evidence the project decision needs, giving the usability review its purpose.
- 8. qualifier.** Turn 16. A qualifier communicates a result's limitation or condition and must not disappear merely for a cleaner presentation.
- 9. Data validation.** Turn 18. Data validation evaluates evidence against requirements; it is distinct from simply receiving an analytical result.
- 10. corrective record.** Turn 20. The corrective record documents the follow-up without erasing the original gap or pretending the review was always complete.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. SW08

Coordinator: "The affected sample is SW08."

SW08 is the identifier supplied for this separate documentation case.

2. 10:40

Reviewer: "The receipt log records 10:40."

Ten forty is the recorded receipt time, not a fabricated signature time.

3. Mina

Coordinator: "The review owner is Mina."

Mina is explicitly responsible for the usability review in the supplied facts.

4. pending

Reviewer: "The usability decision remains pending."

The case gives no completed decision, so pending preserves its status.

03 Briefing and language checks

Permitting and Agency Coordination

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What does C7 explicitly request?

A. Additional wet-weather modeling

The comment requests wet-weather modeling but leaves the event parameters unspecified.

2. What is Arun's 100-year interpretation?

A. An unconfirmed assumption

Arun proposes an interpretation that the agency has not confirmed.

3. What does Friday represent?

B. An internal response-package target

The team has an internal target, but the agency has made no clarification-date commitment.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which agency question is most useful?

D. For C7, please confirm the storm duration, intensity, and return period.

The useful question references the comment and asks for the specific missing parameters without blame or invention.

2. Which statement overstates the agency's instruction?

D. C7 requires a 100-year event.

The supplied comment does not state a return period, so the asserted requirement is unsupported.

3. What should the response matrix show before clarification arrives?

B. The open parameter question and clarification-request status

An accurate matrix preserves the unresolved question and the actual status of the team's request.

4. What does a 100-year return period not mean?

B. Exactly one occurrence every hundred years

Return period is statistical and does not schedule one event at fixed century intervals.

03 Conversation answers

Permitting and Agency Coordination

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. assumption register.** Turn 2. The assumption register records an unconfirmed interpretation without converting it into an agency instruction.
- 2. modeling scenario.** Turn 4. The modeling scenario requires defined conditions; the broad request does not supply every necessary event parameter.
- 3. written clarification.** Turn 6. Written clarification creates a traceable interpretation of the agency's request instead of relying on an undocumented guess.
- 4. return period.** Turn 8. Return period expresses event frequency statistically; it is neither storm duration nor a guarantee of once-per-century occurrence.
- 5. response deadline.** Turn 10. Here the response deadline is the team's internal target; it must not be represented as an agency commitment.
- 6. permit condition.** Turn 12. A permit condition belongs to an issued authorization; clarification of a modeling request is not permit issuance.
- 7. comment-response matrix.** Turn 14. The comment-response matrix links the original comment, response, and supporting evidence while keeping unresolved items visible.
- 8. model domain.** Turn 16. The model domain defines the represented extent; confirming its applicability is more precise than silently changing that extent.
- 9. version identifier.** Turn 18. The version identifier ties the clarification to the correct model issue and prevents mismatched assumptions across revisions.
- 10. submission package.** Turn 20. The submission package should contain the actual agreed analysis and traceable responses, not unsupported claims of agency approval.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. C12

Consultant: "The unresolved comment reference is C12."

C12 is the specific agency reference supplied for this separate case.

2. hours

Coordinator: "One missing input is the operating hours."

Operating hours are explicitly unspecified and must not be guessed.

3. Dev

Consultant: "The clarification owner is Dev."

Dev is assigned the clarification request in the given facts.

4. Monday

Coordinator: "The internal package target is Monday."

Monday is the team's target, not an agency-guaranteed reply or approval.

04 Briefing and language checks

Remediation Options and Risk

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. Which option has the lower implementation estimate?

C. B at \$90,000

B's stated implementation estimate is lower, but that component excludes its longer monitoring period.

2. What is A's stated monitoring cost?

C. \$60,000

Twelve months multiplied by five thousand dollars gives sixty thousand dollars for A's monitoring component.

3. What remains unresolved?

D. Technical suitability and regulatory acceptability

The brief explicitly leaves technical suitability, regulatory acceptability, and completion criteria unassessed.

D Language checks / page 36

1. What is B's stated combined total?

B. \$210,000

Ninety thousand plus twenty-four times five thousand equals two hundred ten thousand dollars.

2. Which comparison is accurate?

A. B has shorter implementation but longer monitoring.

The supplied periods are two versus four implementation weeks and twenty-four versus twelve monitoring months.

3. Which recommendation exceeds the evidence?

D. Select A because its lower stated total proves technical suitability.

The cost difference does not establish whether either remedy is technically suitable or acceptable.

4. What should appear beside the totals?

A. Included components, undiscounted basis, exclusions, and unresolved criteria

The comparison depends on its stated components and assumptions, while technical and acceptance questions remain unresolved.

04 Conversation answers

Remediation Options and Risk

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. implementation period. Turn 2. Implementation period covers the stated active work, not the later monitoring or all completion obligations.

2. monitoring period. Turn 4. Monitoring period determines the number of monthly costs in this limited comparison: twelve for A and twenty-four for B.

3. undiscounted estimate. Turn 6. An undiscounted estimate adds the stated future amounts without present-value adjustment and does not remove uncertainty or exclusions.

4. Feasibility. Turn 8. Feasibility concerns practical suitability under site conditions; the limited cost calculation does not establish it.

5. completion criterion. Turn 10. The completion criterion defines when obligations are fulfilled; implementation duration alone cannot establish that endpoint.

6. performance criterion. Turn 12. A performance criterion states how success will be evaluated; a short schedule does not demonstrate that outcome.

7. regulatory acceptability. Turn 14. Regulatory acceptability requires relevant review against applicable expectations; a commercial estimate does not supply that decision.

8. life-cycle cost. Turn 16. Life-cycle cost spans defined stages and costs; this limited table excludes other costs and is not a complete analysis.

9. contingency allowance. Turn 18. A contingency allowance addresses specified cost uncertainty; none is included in the supplied figures, so it cannot be assumed.

10. remedial objective. Turn 20. The remedial objective defines the environmental outcome sought; choosing a price or schedule does not establish that the outcome is achievable.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 12,000

Consultant: "C's monitoring component is 12,000 dollars."

Six monitoring months at two thousand dollars total twelve thousand dollars.

2. 52,000

Client: "C's stated combined estimate is 52,000 dollars."

Forty thousand plus twelve thousand equals fifty-two thousand on the limited basis.

3. 59,000

Consultant: "D's stated combined estimate is 59,000 dollars."

Thirty-five thousand plus twenty-four thousand equals fifty-nine thousand on the same basis.

4. unassessed

Client: "Technical suitability remains unassessed."

The brief explicitly leaves suitability unresolved despite the completed arithmetic.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Regulatory Compliance and Audits

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. How many findings are verified closed?

C. Two

F1 and F2 have the required effectiveness evidence and are closed under the stated local process.

2. How many findings remain open?

B. Four

F3-F6 remain open: two await effectiveness checks and two lack plans and owners.

3. What is missing for F5 and F6?

C. Both a documented action plan and an assigned owner

The brief explicitly states that F5 and F6 have neither plans nor owners.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which dashboard headline is accurate?

D. Two closed, two awaiting effectiveness checks, two without plans or owners.

The accurate headline preserves all three distinct states supplied in the brief.

2. What is the verified closure rate?

A. Approximately 33.3%

Two verified closures divided by six total findings gives approximately thirty-three point three percent.

3. What must not be inferred from Thursday's review time?

A. All findings will be resolved by then.

A status-review appointment is not a commitment that every corrective action will be complete.

4. Which record best supports closure in this case?

D. Verified effectiveness evidence linked to the finding

The local process explicitly requires effectiveness evidence rather than the mere existence of a plan.

05 Conversation answers

Regulatory Compliance and Audits

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. corrective-action plan. Turn 2. A corrective-action plan documents intended work; its existence alone does not establish implementation or verified effectiveness.

2. open finding. Turn 4. An open finding has not met the stated closure requirements, even if a plan and owner already exist.

3. action owner. Turn 6. The action owner is accountable for follow-up; assigning that person is necessary coordination, not evidence that the finding is resolved.

4. escalation route. Turn 8. The escalation route raises unresolved responsibility through the agreed process rather than hiding the ownership gap in the report.

5. closure rate. Turn 10. Closure rate uses findings meeting the closure condition as its numerator; here that is two of six, not four planned actions.

6. audit scope. Turn 12. Audit scope limits what the review covers; a finding-closure percentage cannot establish a percentage of overall facility compliance.

7. evidence register. Turn 14. The evidence register links each claimed closure to its supporting information, making the status reviewable rather than merely asserted.

8. effectiveness check. Turn 16. An effectiveness check evaluates the action's result; pending means that evaluation is incomplete, not necessarily that the action failed.

9. target date. Turn 18. The target date here is for a status review, not a promised completion date for every corrective action.

10. audit trail. Turn 20. The audit trail records how evidence and decisions support status changes, including the correction of a misleading dashboard count.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. three

Coordinator: "The number verified closed is three."

Three findings explicitly meet the verified-closure condition in the supplied case.

2. five

Reviewer: "The number still open is five."

Eight total findings minus three verified closures leaves five open findings.

3. 37.5%

Coordinator: "The verified closure rate is 37.5%."

Three divided by eight equals thirty-seven point five percent of this review's findings.

4. Monday

Reviewer: "The next status review is Monday."

Monday is the review appointment, not a guaranteed resolution date.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Sustainability and ESG Reporting

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What does the 40-tonne estimate cover?

A. Purchased electricity at two offices during 2025

The calculation explicitly covers purchased electricity for two offices in the stated year.

2. Which headline is unsupported?

A. Our company is carbon neutral.

A partial electricity estimate does not substantiate a company-wide carbon-neutrality claim.

3. What must not be inferred from excluded sources?

C. Their emissions are zero.

Exclusion means a source was not included, not that it produced no emissions.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which replacement headline is supported?

B. Estimated 2025 purchased-electricity emissions for two offices: 40 tonnes CO₂e.

The accurate headline preserves the activity, two-office boundary, year, estimate status, and unit.

2. Which statement about Scope 2 is accurate?

A. It can include purchased heat, steam, and cooling as well as electricity.

Scope 2 covers relevant purchased or acquired energy categories, not only the electricity subset in this case.

3. What does lack of independent assurance mean here?

C. The estimate must not be described as independently assured.

No assurance engagement has established independent assurance, but its absence does not itself prove the estimate false.

4. Which question addresses the headline's main defect?

A. Does the evidence cover and substantiate the company-wide claim?

The main defect is the mismatch between a narrow calculation and a broad unsubstantiated claim.

06 Conversation answers

Sustainability and ESG Reporting

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. emissions inventory. Turn 2. An emissions inventory has defined boundaries; this calculation covers only the stated electricity sources rather than the whole company.

2. reporting boundary. Turn 4. The reporting boundary states what is included, preventing a partial office estimate from becoming a company-wide assertion.

3. CO2e. Turn 6. CO2e expresses emissions on a common warming-potential basis; it is not a unit of electricity consumption.

4. Scope 2. Turn 8. Scope 2 includes relevant purchased or acquired energy, so selected office electricity is only a subset of its potential coverage.

5. Scope 1. Turn 10. Scope 1 concerns direct emissions from owned or controlled sources under the chosen boundary; omitted sources cannot be presumed zero.

6. Scope 3. Turn 12. Scope 3 addresses other indirect value-chain emissions under the framework, which are outside this limited calculation.

7. Assurance. Turn 14. Assurance is an independent evaluation under an agreed engagement; internal preparation alone does not establish that status.

8. carbon credit. Turn 16. A carbon credit is a separate quantified unit under a program; purchasing it does not supply a complete inventory or substantiate every claim.

9. base year. Turn 18. A base year provides a defined comparison reference; no comparable prior-year calculation is supplied in this case.

10. emission factor. Turn 20. The emission factor links activity data to the calculated emissions and should be documented with the method and boundary.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. 12

Analyst: "The estimated emissions are 12 tonnes CO2e."

Twelve is the emissions quantity supplied for this separate limited calculation.

2. warehouse

Editor: "The included location is one warehouse."

The calculation covers one warehouse, not every company operation.

3. 2024

Analyst: "The reporting year is 2024."

The supplied reporting period is 2024 and must remain attached to the figure.

4. not

Editor: "Independent assurance has not been completed."

The brief explicitly states that independent assurance has not been completed.

07 Briefing and language checks

Community and Stakeholder Meetings

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What does the sampling cover?

C. Three locations on one June morning

The brief limits the results to three locations, one collection period, and the listed analytes.

2. What does below the reporting limit establish?

C. The laboratory did not report a quantitative value at or above that limit for X.

A below-limit result is tied to the laboratory reporting basis and does not prove universal absence or safety.

3. Where should requests for current health or water-use advice go?

A. The responsible public authority

The consultant must refer these advice questions to the responsible authority rather than inventing a determination.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which public statement is accurate?

A. X was below the reporting limit in these three preliminary samples.

The supported statement preserves the analyte, sample count, analytical limit, and preliminary status.

2. Which phrase improperly expands time coverage?

B. The area is safe in every season.

Every season claims evidence beyond the single collection period supplied in the case.

3. How should Suki respond to a drinking-water question?

A. Acknowledge the concern and refer current advice to the responsible authority.

The study does not establish drinking-water advice, so Suki should acknowledge the question and use the appropriate referral.

4. Which comparison is correct?

B. Screening levels and cleanup levels serve different purposes.

Screening values support further evaluation and are not automatically the applicable cleanup criteria or a health determination.

07 Conversation answers

Community and Stakeholder Meetings

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. spatial coverage.** Turn 2. Spatial coverage identifies represented places; three sampling locations do not characterize the whole area.
- 2. analyte.** Turn 4. Analyte names the tested substance; the result concerns X rather than every possible substance.
- 3. plain-language summary.** Turn 6. A plain-language summary simplifies wording without replacing the result's limits with a misleading label.
- 4. temporal coverage.** Turn 8. Temporal coverage identifies represented times; one morning does not establish conditions throughout the year.
- 5. responsible authority.** Turn 10. The responsible authority provides current advice; the consultant must not invent guidance from these limited results.
- 6. follow-up contact.** Turn 12. A follow-up contact offers further communication without implying that the study answers the water-use question.
- 7. screening level.** Turn 14. A screening level supports further evaluation, not an automatic cleanup criterion or universal safety determination.
- 8. preliminary result.** Turn 16. A preliminary result can be explained with its stage and limits; preliminary does not mean false.
- 9. question log.** Turn 18. The question log keeps community concerns and their follow-up status visible, including unresolved questions.
- 10. risk communication.** Turn 20. Risk communication combines accurate evidence and uncertainty with respectful attention to affected people's practical concerns.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. two

Consultant: "The report covers two locations."

P1 and P2 are the two locations explicitly included in the report.

2. 8 May

Resident: "The collection date was 8 May."

Eight May is the supplied sampling date, not a claim about other periods.

3. Y

Consultant: "The reported analyte is Y."

Y is the only analyte included in this separate report.

4. preliminary

Resident: "The results are still preliminary."

The supplied report is preliminary and must not be presented as a final determination.

08 Briefing and language checks

Proposal, Scope, and Client Expectations

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What does the existing agreement cover?

C. Six locations during one visit, with agreed laboratory work and report

The signed assignment specifies six locations and one visit; the requested additions are not yet approved.

2. What is requested as additional work?

A. Four more locations and a second visit

Grace requests four additional locations and another visit beyond the existing agreement.

3. What does Wednesday at 12:00 represent?

A. A change-estimate status update

Malik promises an estimate-status update, not delivery, field access, or approval of additional work.

D Language checks / page 72

1. If the request is approved, how many locations would be included?

D. Ten locations, with sample count still to be determined

Six plus four gives ten locations, but the brief does not establish the number of samples.

2. Which reply is cooperative and accurate?

A. We can assess the extra work and provide estimate status Wednesday at noon.

The accurate reply offers a concrete assessment step without inventing authorization, cost, or delivery commitments.

3. What is required before extra field work under this agreement?

B. An approved written change

The fictional agreement expressly requires approved written authorization for the additional field work.

4. Which schedule statement is unsupported?

A. The laboratory turnaround equals the full report-delivery period.

Laboratory work is only one component; collection, review, access, and reporting also affect the schedule.

08 Conversation answers

Proposal, Scope, and Client Expectations

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. change request.** Turn 2. The change request proposes extra work; it does not itself amend the agreement or authorize performance.
- 2. sample count.** Turn 4. Sample count depends on the sampling design and quality requirements, not simply the number of locations.
- 3. analytical suite.** Turn 6. The analytical suite defines the testing included; changing locations does not by itself specify the laboratory work required.
- 4. site access.** Turn 8. Site access is an unresolved practical dependency; drafting a proposal does not establish permission or a confirmed visit.
- 5. fee estimate.** Turn 10. The fee estimate projects charges on a defined basis; the promised status update does not guarantee every pricing input will be resolved.
- 6. cost breakdown.** Turn 12. The cost breakdown separates estimate components so the client can review what the proposed change adds and excludes.
- 7. Laboratory turnaround.** Turn 14. Laboratory turnaround covers the stated laboratory service period, not all access, collection, review, and reporting steps.
- 8. change authorization.** Turn 16. Change authorization requires the approved written change specified by this agreement; discussion or interest alone does not permit extra field work.
- 9. scope of work.** Turn 18. The scope of work remains the agreed six-location assignment until the parties approve a change; a request does not silently replace it.
- 10. client sign-off.** Turn 20. Client sign-off documents approval under the agreement; arranging a review is not the same as receiving that approval.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. eight

Manager: "The proposed expanded scope would cover eight locations."

Five existing plus three requested locations equals eight if the change is approved.

2. second

Client: "The requested visit would be the second visit."

The client requests a second visit beyond the one already agreed.

3. unresolved

Manager: "The sample count is still unresolved."

Location arithmetic does not determine the sample count, which the brief leaves unresolved.

4. change

Client: "Before extra field work, we need an approved written change."

The supplied agreement explicitly requires an approved written change before additional field work.

08

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Phase I and Phase II Site Assessments

Identify the outstanding source: The tank-closure record has not arrived.

Separate absence from proof: A missing record does not prove either a release or its absence.

Avoid an automatic next step: No Phase II investigation has been authorized.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Sampling Plans and Data Quality

Locate the gap: The receiving-signature box for GW03 is blank.

State corroborating information: The receipt log records arrival at 16:25.

Request a clarification: Please provide a traceable account of the handoff.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Permitting and Agency Coordination

Cite the comment: We are responding to comment C7.

Identify missing inputs: The duration, intensity, and return period are unspecified.

Keep the record organized: Link the reply to the comment-response matrix.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Remediation Options and Risk

Define the question: Best depends on the criteria we are comparing.

State the limited total: A totals \$180,000 on this stated basis.

Separate duration measures: Implementation time is not the full monitoring period.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Regulatory Compliance and Audits

Correct the headline: Four findings have plans, but only two are closed.

Describe the pending checks: F3 and F4 remain open pending effectiveness checks.

Limit the percentage: That is approximately 33.3% of this review's findings.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Sustainability and ESG Reporting

Name the measured activity: The estimate covers purchased electricity at two offices.

Limit the boundary: This is not a company-wide emissions inventory.

State assurance status: Independent assurance has not been completed.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Community and Stakeholder Meetings

Acknowledge the concern: I understand that you need information for everyday decisions.

Explain the result: X was below the laboratory reporting limit in these samples.

Limit the time: One sampling event does not represent every season.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Proposal, Scope, and Client Expectations

Acknowledge the request: You are requesting four additional locations and a second visit.

Clarify quantities: Ten locations would not automatically mean ten samples.

Avoid a free-work assumption: Additional work is not included merely because it is discussed.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceptance condition define the acceptance condition	69
action owner assign an action owner	41
activity data collect activity data	50
additional service price an additional service	68
adjoining property review adjoining property uses	6
agency comment respond to an agency comment	23
all appropriate inquiries (AAI) evaluate AAI requirements	5
analyte list the target analytes	59
analytical suite define the analytical suite	69
annual exceedance probability explain annual exceedance probability	23
area-wide claim qualify an area-wide claim	60
assumption document a pricing assumption	68
assumption register maintain an assumption register	24
assurance obtain independent assurance	51
audit criterion identify the audit criterion	41
audit scope agree the audit scope	41
audit trail preserve the audit trail	42
authorization obtain investigation authorization	6
avoided emissions distinguish avoided emissions	51
base year establish a base year	51
baseline condition define the baseline condition	23
boundary condition document a boundary condition	23
calibration document model calibration	24
carbon credit examine carbon credit documentation	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

carbon dioxide equivalent (CO2e)	report tonnes of CO2e	50
carbon-neutrality claim	substantiate a carbon-neutrality claim	51
chain of custody (COC)	maintain chain of custody	14
change authorization	obtain change authorization	68
change request	assess a change request	68
cleanup level	identify the applicable cleanup level	59
client sign-off	obtain client sign-off	69
closure evidence	retain closure evidence	42
closure rate	calculate the closure rate	42
comment-response matrix	update the comment-response matrix	23
commercial review	complete commercial review	69
community liaison	appoint a community liaison	59
completion criterion	confirm the completion criterion	33
compliance obligation	identify a compliance obligation	41
conceptual site model	refine the conceptual site model	32
containment	assess a containment approach	32
contaminant of concern	identify a contaminant of concern	32
contingency allowance	define the contingency allowance	33
correction	document the immediate correction	41
corrective action	verify corrective action	41
corrective record	retain the corrective record	15
corrective-action plan	approve a corrective-action plan	41
cost breakdown	provide a cost breakdown	68
custodian	identify the receiving custodian	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

data gap identify a data gap	5
data quality objective (DQO) define a data quality objective	14
data usability assess data usability	15
data validation conduct data validation	15
deliverable confirm the deliverable	68
demobilization account for demobilization	68
dependency identify a schedule dependency	69
detection limit identify the detection limit	15
deviation document a deviation	14
dry-weather flow estimate dry-weather flow	23
effectiveness check complete an effectiveness check	42
emission factor document the emission factor	51
emissions inventory compile an emissions inventory	50
engineering control maintain an engineering control	33
environmental professional refer to the environmental professional	5
equipment blank examine an equipment blank	15
escalation route use the escalation route	42
evidence register update the evidence register	42
ex situ treatment compare ex situ treatment	32
exclusion state the exclusion	68
executive summary qualify the executive summary	6
exposure assessment conduct an exposure assessment	59
exposure pathway evaluate an exposure pathway	32
feasibility assess technical feasibility	32

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

fee estimate	prepare a fee estimate	68
field blank	assess a field blank	15
field duplicate	compare a field duplicate	15
finding	record a finding	41
fire insurance map	review a fire insurance map	6
follow-up contact	provide a follow-up contact	60
follow-up request	issue a follow-up request	6
global warming potential (GWP)	state the GWP basis	51
greenhouse gas (GHG)	quantify greenhouse gas emissions	50
historical aerial photograph	compare historical aerial photographs	6
historical land use	investigate historical land use	5
holding time	review the holding time	14
implementation period	estimate the implementation period	33
in situ treatment	evaluate in situ treatment	32
input parameter	confirm an input parameter	24
institutional control	document an institutional control	33
interview record	retain the interview record	6
laboratory control sample	review a laboratory control sample	15
laboratory turnaround	confirm laboratory turnaround	69
lead time	check the lead time	69
life-cycle cost	compare life-cycle costs	33
location-based method	describe the location-based method	51
management review	prepare for management review	42
market-based method	document the market-based method	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

meeting record circulate the meeting record	60
method blank evaluate a method blank	15
mobilization estimate mobilization costs	68
model domain define the model domain	24
modeling scenario specify a modeling scenario	23
monitored natural attenuation evaluate monitored natural attenuation	33
monitoring period define the monitoring period	33
non-detect explain a non-detect	59
nonconformity document a nonconformity	41
not-to-exceed amount confirm the not-to-exceed amount	69
objective evidence examine objective evidence	41
observation record an observation	41
open finding track an open finding	42
operational boundary describe the operational boundary	50
organizational boundary define the organizational boundary	50
overdue action escalate an overdue action	42
performance criterion specify a performance criterion	33
permit application submit a permit application	23
permit condition interpret a permit condition	24
Phase I environmental site assessment conduct a Phase I assessment	5
Phase II investigation scope a Phase II investigation	5
plain-language summary prepare a plain-language summary	60
preliminary result qualify a preliminary result	59
preservation document sample preservation	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

professional opinion	support a professional opinion	6
public advisory	check the current public advisory	60
public meeting	prepare a public meeting	59
purchased electricity	quantify purchased electricity use	50
purchased heat	account for purchased heat	50
qualifier	interpret a data qualifier	15
quality assurance project plan (QAPP)	review the QAPP	14
quantitation	describe the quantitation limit	59
question log	maintain a question log	60
rainfall intensity	state rainfall intensity	23
receipt log	check the receipt log	14
receptor	identify a potential receptor	32
recognized environmental condition (REC)	evaluate a potential REC	6
records review	complete the records review	5
recurring finding	investigate a recurring finding	42
regulatory acceptability	assess regulatory acceptability	33
regulatory database	search a regulatory database	6
release	investigate a reported release	5
remedial objective	establish a remedial objective	32
remediation	evaluate remediation options	32
reporting allowance	include a reporting allowance	69
reporting boundary	disclose the reporting boundary	51
reporting limit	state the reporting limit	15
reporting year	specify the reporting year	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

representativeness evaluate representativeness	60
residual risk evaluate residual risk	33
response deadline verify the response deadline	24
responsible authority contact the responsible authority	60
retirement verify credit retirement	51
return period specify the return period	23
review cycle plan the review cycle	24
risk communication improve risk communication	60
root cause investigate the root cause	41
sample count verify the sample count	69
sample identifier verify the sample identifier	14
sampling event describe the sampling event	59
sampling location identify the sampling location	59
sampling plan follow the sampling plan	14
schedule impact assess the schedule impact	69
Scope 1 report Scope 1 emissions	50
Scope 2 calculate Scope 2 emissions	50
Scope 3 assess Scope 3 categories	50
scope of inquiry confirm the scope of inquiry	5
scope of work define the scope of work	68
screening level interpret a screening level	59
sensitivity analysis conduct sensitivity analysis	24
significant data gap assess a significant data gap	6
site access confirm site access	68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

site reconnaissance	document site reconnaissance	5
source area	characterize the source area	32
source limitation	disclose a source limitation	5
spatial coverage	explain spatial coverage	60
stakeholder	engage a stakeholder	59
storm duration	confirm the storm duration	23
subject property	define the subject property	6
submission package	revise the submission package	24
tank-closure record	request the tank-closure record	5
target date	agree a target date	42
technical memorandum	prepare a technical memorandum	24
temporal coverage	explain temporal coverage	60
traceable amendment	make a traceable amendment	14
transfer signature	obtain the required transfer signature	14
treatability study	scope a treatability study	32
trip blank	review a trip blank	15
uncertainty	communicate uncertainty	60
undiscounted estimate	present an undiscounted estimate	33
value chain	map the value chain	50
verification status	report verification status	42
version identifier	retain the version identifier	24
wet-weather event	characterize a wet-weather event	23
work order	issue a work order	69
written clarification	obtain written clarification	24

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] U.S. Environmental Protection Agency. Brownfields All Appropriate Inquiries.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on environmental site inquiries, professional review, and assessment context. The fictional site is not an AAI determination or an opinion about liability protection. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] U.S. Environmental Protection Agency, Region 4. Sample and Evidence Management.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on traceable sample custody and documentation. This regional procedure is not a universal rule; the fictional missing signature concerns a field-team-to-laboratory handoff required by the stated project plan, not a common-carrier signature. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] U.S. Environmental Protection Agency. Regional Screening Levels: User Guide.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on screening, site-specific evaluation, and exposure context. No actual screening value or cleanup criterion is supplied or prescribed. Checked 1 October 2026.

[4] Greenhouse Gas Protocol. Corporate Accounting and Reporting Standard.

[Open the original source](#)

Background vocabulary for organizational boundaries and emissions scopes. The book does not certify an inventory, establish carbon neutrality, or treat standards under revision as adopted requirements. Checked 1 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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